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COMMUNITY FORESTS PROGRAM

FINAL REPORT 2014 - 2019

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Principal contacts:

Hassan Sachedina, Chief of Party, CFP, hassan@biocarbonpartners.com

Alastair Anton, Director Operations, aanton@biocarbonpartners.com

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LIST OF ACRONYMS

BCP	BioCarbon Partners Limited
CBNRM	Community Based Natural Resources Management
CEO	Chief Executive Officer
CFMA	Community Forest Monitoring Agreement
CFP	Community Forests Program
CLZ	Conservation Lower Zambezi
CRB	Community Resources Board
CSO	Civil Society Organisation
DNPW	Department of National Parks and Wildlife
EWSC	Eastern Water and Sewerage Company
FD	Forestry Department
FGD	Focus Group Discussions
FREL	Forest Reference Emission Level
GHG	Greenhouse Gases
GIS	Geographic Information System
GRZ	Government of the Republic of Zambia
HACCP	Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Point
ISFL	Initiative for Sustainable Forest Landscapes
LoP	Life of Project
LZRP	Lower Zambezi REDD+ Project
M&E	Monitoring and Evaluation
MIS	Management Information Systems
MOCTA	Ministry of Chiefs and Traditional Affairs
MOU	Memorandum of Understanding
NGO	Non-governmental Organization
NRM	Natural Resource Management
PFMA	Participatory Forest Management Agreement
PLA	Participatory Learning and Action
PPP	Public Private Partnership
REDD+	Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation
RS	Remote Sensing
SOP	Standard Operating Procedure
USAID	United States Agency for International Development
USG	United States Government
VAG	Village Action Group
VER	Verified Emissions Reductions
VCS	Verified Carbon Standard
VCU	Verified Carbon Unit

A photograph of a man with a beard and short hair, wearing a green button-down shirt, standing in a lush green cornfield. He is looking directly at the camera with a slight smile. The corn plants are tall and vibrant green, with some tassels visible. The text 'USAID COMMUNITY FORESTS PROGRAM' is overlaid in white, bold, sans-serif capital letters on the left side of the image. Below the title is a short horizontal white line.

USAID COMMUNITY FORESTS PROGRAM

2014-2019

I. PROJECT DESCRIPTION

In February 2014, USAID/Zambia's Cooperative Agreement to BioCarbon Partners, Ltd. (BCP) was started to implement the Community Forests Program (CFP) in Zambia. The CFP was designed to exemplify and support the Government of Zambia's (GRZ) Reducing Emission from Deforestation and Degradation (REDD+) strategy by establishing the largest REDD+ program to-date in Zambia. The CFP aimed to establish REDD+ project areas across a minimum of 700,000 hectares within the Lower Zambezi and Luangwa Valley ecosystems, and in so doing, support deforestation mitigation activities taking place on a total of up to 2 million hectares, involving up to 10,000 households. Tetra Tech ARD was a sub-awardee to the agreement charged with supporting BCP in the management of the CA.

The goal of the CFP was to establish a community based REDD+ project to improve natural resources management, particularly forests, through joint management, increased capacities, and improved livelihoods of forest dependent communities.

This overall program goal was achieved through three interrelated objectives:

- Zambian institutional and community capacity for REDD+ and forest management increased;
- Joint management of natural resources, particularly forests, improved, through REDD+ activities;
- Livelihoods in forest dependent communities improved through carbon revenues and other alternative livelihoods.

The CFP had to implement several foundational steps in developing a large-scale community based REDD+ project:

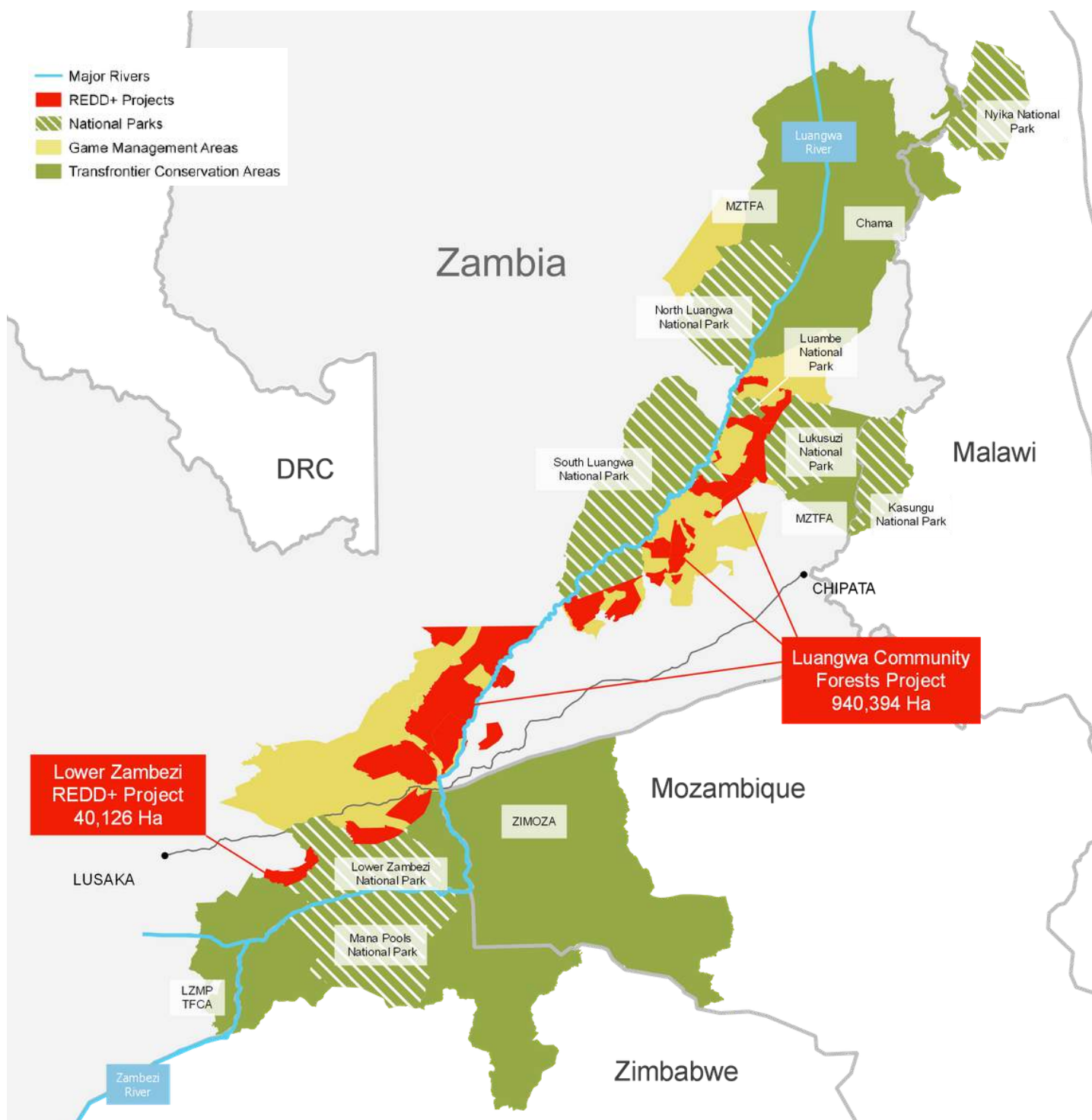
- Identifying potential REDD+ conservation areas with communities and Government.
- Design a Zambia-specific and effective Free Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) process that meets local and international standards for community engagement.
- Developing and negotiating 30-year community agreements committing each party to their responsibilities and defining benefit sharing.
- Developing community organizational capacity to equitably and transparently manage carbon revenues and community development projects.
- Developing community capacity to protect and conserve community forest assets.
- Helping to develop and implement an enabling legal framework in a globally new sector to catalyze the first communities in Zambia to be transferred carbon rights.
- Submitting a Project Document to the Verified Carbon Standard (VCS) with confirmed maps and carbon offset calculations.
- Verification of the PD by an independent auditor, leading to the VCS approving the project and verified carbon offsets that can be sold to sustain project activities.

BCP worked closely with Government of Zambia (GRZ) institutions to build their capacity to better implement and support REDD+ while ensuring the CFP's efforts fit within the Zambian policy and legal framework. These partners included the Forest Department (FD), the Department of National Parks and Wildlife (DNPW), the Ministry of Chiefs and Traditional Affairs (MOCTA), as well as District and Provincial local government offices.

The majority of CFP was located within Game Management Areas (GMAs): areas in the law that are assigned a conservation land use designation, and under a dual-administration mandate of DNPW and Traditional Authorities. As a result, CFP engaged with Traditional Authorities and other community institutions with legal recognition such as Community Resource Boards (CRBs) and their associated Village Action Group (VAG) membership foundations. These institutions became the mechanism by which communities were empowered to manage, and own, forest carbon rights; the first time this has happened in Zambia.

The project relied heavily on technical expertise in REDD+ monitoring and verification processes from BCP Limited's parent company BCP Mauritius. Such expertise was absolutely necessary to ensure compliance and high quality certification with the rigorous requirements of the independent international criteria of the Verified Carbon Standard (VCS) as well as the Climate, Community and Biodiversity (CCB) Standard. The CFP target was "triple gold" under the CCB; the highest rating possible for exceptional and measurable social, environmental and climate benefits.

Figure I Project Area Map



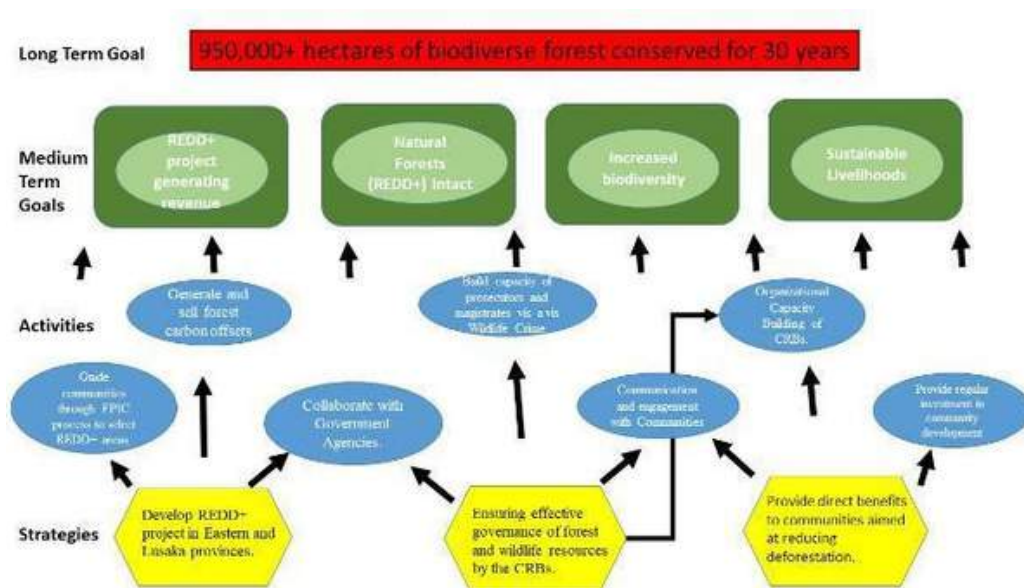
CFP THEORY OF CHANGE

To better design and plan intended impacts, the CFP developed a theory of change which articulated the three key strategies for ensuring the long term goal of conserving biodiverse forests in Zambia. These strategies included:

- Developing a REDD+ project;
- Ensuring effective governance by CRBs; and
- Providing direct benefits to communities aimed at reducing deforestation.

The Theory of Change provides an analysis framework for long-term monitoring and evaluation of the 30 year REDD+ project started by CFP.

Figure 2 Summary of the CFP Theory of Change





2. CFP SUMMARY OF ACCOMPLISHMENTS

This summary is presented according to the 3 key strategies of the CFP Theory of Change, presented as figure 2 on page 10.

2.1 ESTABLISHING THE LUANGWA COMMUNITY FORESTS PROJECT

BCP is in the process of finalizing one of the largest REDD+ projects in Africa thanks to the USAID/Zambia investment in the Community Forests Program. The 30 year project has been registered with the VCS as the “Luangwa Community Forests Project” to take advantage of the marketing benefits of one of Africa’s greatest wildlife strongholds.

The five-year USAID/CFP catalyzed the LCFP which is designed to yield transformational social, environmental and financial returns in areas of high biodiversity value. In the absence of LCFP succeeding, these areas are projected to generate low financial returns without carbon finance. The CFP effort required exhaustive community engagement to ensure communities were making informed decisions about the future management of their forest assets. Essential to success was the involvement and goodwill of the Government of Zambia, throughout. While USAID support for the CFP ended before final VCS verification of the project was achieved, works are continuing to complete this process to ensure sustainable development results are realised.



2.1.1 SITE SELECTION AND THE FPIC PROCESS (FLYING FPIC)

Site selection and ensuring communities gave Free Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) to establish REDD+ areas on their land required extensive work engaging with communities and other stakeholders to assess the extent of forested areas from the Lower Zambezi to North Luangwa National Park, along the Luangwa River valley.

The CFP worked with GRZ and Civil Society Organizations (CSOs) to develop a detailed FPIC standard operating procedure (SOP) which was audited by SCS Global, an international forest carbon auditing firm. A total of 12 chiefdoms completed the process which covered FPIC activities at District Government, Chiefdom and village levels. The steps included:

Introductory meetings, to provide community members with critical information about BCP, CFP and REDD+, to allow them to make an informed decision;

Participatory Learning and Action (PLA) / Participatory Rural Appraisal (PRA) techniques, to solicit community inputs to identify:

- Local drivers of deforestation
- Deforestation mitigation activities that could help to address/reduce these drivers of deforestation.

Participatory Forest Selection meetings, where members of the community reviewed maps of their Chiefdom forests, and had the opportunity to provide feedback in terms

of: Areas of community forest to be protected through REDD+

- Potential deforestation mitigation activities to be followed

“Flying FPIC” activities, a BCP innovation that allowed representatives from the local communities – including Chiefdom, CRB and VAG members — as well as GRZ representatives, to be flown over their forest resources, in order to confirm the forests, the boundaries and absence of community conflict. This innovation was necessary as LCFP evolved into Africa’s largest REDD+ project, and operated in areas with low roads networks, and major river barriers. Given the scale of the exercise, multi-stakeholder walking all of the boundaries would not have been an effective land use planning approach.

“Ground Truthing” activities, where BCP facilitated community and government representatives to visit targeted and strategic boundaries prior to confirming them. This was usually in the case of contested or boundaries close to villages. The combination of aerial, vehicle and walking boundary verification enabled the LCFP to sign long-term agreements over 940,000 ha of forests; 34% higher than CFP’s life of project target of 700,000 ha.

Follow-Up / Finalization Meetings, in which the final proposed boundaries for REDD+ forest protection were presented to the wider communities for validation. This was an additional opportunity for community members to provide any final feedback before approving or rejecting the proposal for the REDD+ project to proceed to implementation. GRZ Officers were involved in or facilitated many of these steps.

18,000+

people participating
in FPIC meetings.

200+

FPIC meetings with
CRBs and VAGs

36

FPIC flights with 140+
community members.

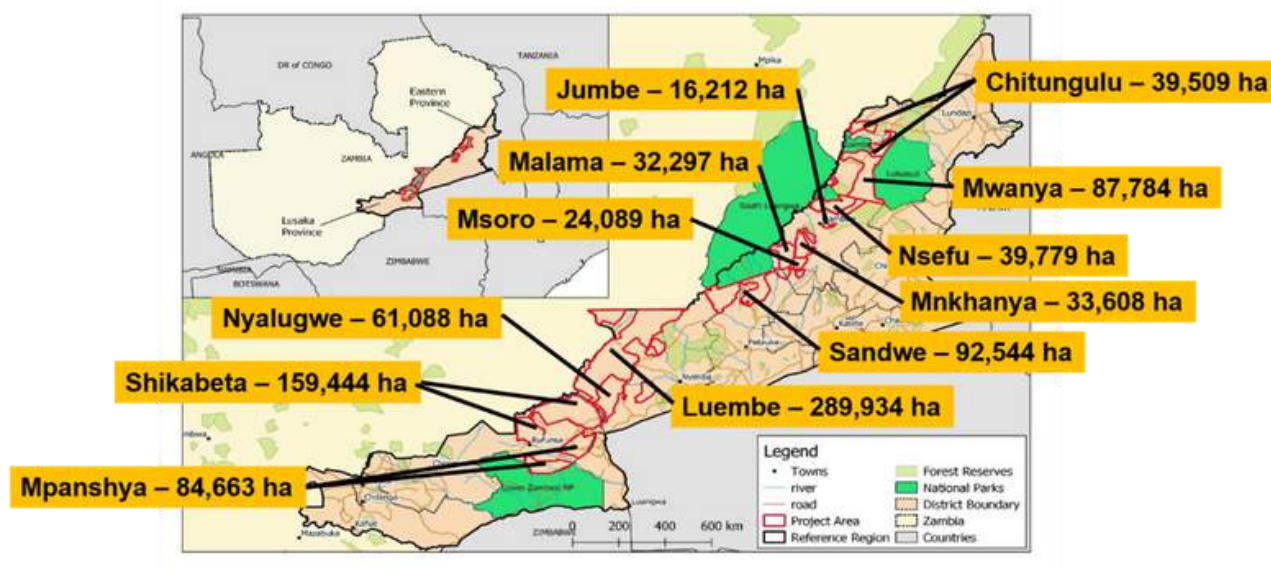
2.1.2 PERMANENT COMMUNITY AGREEMENTS

The FPIC process was initiated by “consent letters” from twelve Chiefdoms working with CFP to allow the project to conduct feasibility studies of the Chiefdoms to get to a decision point whether the Chiefdom would be a viable addition to a large scale REDD+ project. These 12 Chiefdoms (and 12 CRBs) were comprised of 69 VAGs. This led to another round of intensive engagement with District Governments, Chiefs, CRB's and VAGs to seek clarity whether at the VAG level, there was community consent to embark on a 30 year forest protection project. The 30 years was selected as a minimum requirement in the VCS rules for a forest to qualify for “permanence” and thus forest carbon offset crediting. The outcome of this process was “Chiefdom Start Date Letters”. This signified when each Chiefdom committed to joining a long-term emissions-reducing forest protection partnership.

Following the Chiefdom Start Date Letters, a process with GRZ, CRBs and Traditional Authorities was embarked upon to develop a template of a 30 year ‘Community Forest Management Agreement’, or CFMA. This is a legally binding contract committing communities and BCP to roles and responsibilities to keep the forest protected and the communities incentivised. In food insecure communities prone to various shocks which entrench and institutionalize poverty, developing an agreement which 12 Chiefdoms were comfortable with was a project milestone. Also critical at this point was agreement on benefit distribution plans detailing how the proceeds from carbon offset sales would be used to ensure management of the forests and long term development for communities. Ensuring that the same formula was agreeable to 12 communities illustrates the engagement skills which the CFP team built during the project, and fundamentally the overall perception of fairness in this business partnership between communities and a private developer.

12 Community Resource Boards and **69** Village Action Groups agree to protect nearly 1 million hectares of REDD+ forest.

Map of LCFP REDD+ Forest area by CRB.



2.1.3 INVOLVING AND SUPPORTING GRZ EFFECTIVELY

Key to the success of the CFP was the involvement of Government of Zambia representatives from district, provincial and national levels.

The Forest Department (FD) was critical as the legal entity charged with management of forests and with jurisdiction over REDD+ projects in Zambia through the 2015 Forests Act, 2015. The CFP supported 12 CRBs to apply for Community Forest Management Group (CFMG) status as the co-management entity over community forests under the Act. The CFP also supported a combined GRZ effort to finalize a Statutory Instrument for Community Forest Management under the 2015 Act, as well as to advance a draft SI under the same law regarding forest carbon management and trading. This involved a process of engaging and planning with a group of 12 GRZ Officers from CFP partner agencies.

DNPW as the responsible agency for the Game Management Areas where almost all the LCFP community REDD+ forest areas are located, was also essential to the success of the CFP. DNPW staff at district, provincial and national levels were involved in every step of the process of developing and approving the LCFP.

The Ministry of Chiefs and Traditional Affairs (MOCTA) was also a key partner in the CFP. MOCTA supported introductions and negotiations with Traditional Authorities and to provide GRZ oversight regarding community safeguards.

The Zambia National Climate Change Secretariat played an important early coordination and support role to the CFP as the national entity charged with supporting climate change mitigation and adaptation in Zambia. BCP participated in regular meetings and workshops organized by the ZNCCS and was a key player in the REDD Working Group, facilitated by the Secretariat.

4 GRZ Agencies 2 Provincial Offices 5 District Governments
with increased capacity to manage and participate in REDD+.

2.1.4 VCS VERIFICATION

The Verified Carbon Standard (VCS) provides a means to certify REDD+ projects so that potential buyers of carbon offsets can be assured of the quality of those offsets. In other words, VCS verification of a REDD+ project certifies that the project meets certain international standards in terms of ensuring quantifiable carbon emissions reductions, tangible community benefits and in the case of the biodiversity benefits as well. Once a project has been verified it can sell its Verified Carbon Units (VCUs) on the voluntary market. As of the end of the CFP, BCP was still engaged in the process of VCS verification for LCFP and expects to complete the process by September 2019 and begin sales of VCUs immediately thereafter. However, the USAID/CFP supported the verification process of the Lower Zambezi REDD+ Project, which—with USAID support—has become the world's only REDD+ project with 5 successful VCS verifications and triple gold CCB verification. This illustrates the verification capacity which was built through the USAID/CFP which positions Africa as a global leader in the development of high quality REDD+ project development.

2.1.5. DEVELOPING SALES AND MARKETING

A key risk to REDD+ projects is market risk, as companies or individuals are not required by law to buy forest carbon offsets.

The sale of VCUs on the voluntary carbon market is ultimately what will drive the sustainability of the CFP. The CFP team invested considerable effort in developing marketing strategies and materials and identifying and approaching potential buyers. Using the Lower Zambezi REDD+ Project (LZRP) as a model, BCP has pursued multiple kinds of potential buyers including:

- Individuals interested in offsetting their personal carbon footprint, through direct online sales.
- Local Zambian tourism businesses interested in supporting the important biodiversity protection that BCP offers through the LCFP.
- Large international corporations that are interested in carbon projects with strong community and biodiversity benefits to offset large pollution footprints.

As at the end of CFP funding, BCP had lined up multi-year sales agreements with corporations to purchase VCUs which will provide immediate revenue for community development upon verification.

1,000,000 tons of carbon offset annually (on average) for the next 30 years.

15 Offsetting Partner Client Relationships Developed



2.2 ENSURING EFFECTIVE GOVERNANCE OF REDD+ PROJECTS

Per VCS rules, REDD+ projects have a 30-year timeline in order to ensure permanence in terms of carbon stock management. Without effective governance systems and enforcement ability, these forests areas will not survive long term.

The CFP invested heavily in the development of CRB capacities and governance systems. The CFP also invested in systems to pick up encroachment in protected forests using aircraft, rather than waiting up to a year for appropriate satellite imagery to become freely available. This helped to locate and address encroachment before it spread. DNPW, CRB and BCP staff were trained in systems and technology to collect aerial encroachment and other illegal activity data. This includes data capture using Back Country Navigator, QGIS mapping software, and GoPro camera video and still capture presented in powerpoint. In addition, systems such as a “Breach Activation Tool” were developed to enable GRZ with BCP support to empower CRBs and Traditional Authorities to protect their forest assets in designated community forests.

Many of the forest boundaries under the 2 REDD+ projects which CFP supported are under clear and present deforestation threat. These two projects are the Lower Zambezi REDD+ Project (LZRP) and the Luangwa Community Forests Project (LCFP).

According to GRZ and international statistics, Zambia has the highest deforestation amount by hectare of any African country. It therefore stands to reason that the remaining forest resources in Lusaka and Eastern Province, many of which fall under the 2 projects, should be under various degrees of threat.

In addition to the deforestation pressure, enforcement capacity is lacking such that in and around CFP project areas, even national parks and private lands are under encroachment risk. Even strict legal protection does not guarantee an area will be free from encroachment in Zambia.

CFP innovated on empowering communities to “socially fence” and to better protect their assets through the facilitation of conflict resolution meetings, development of local level working partnership groups, and by creating more value from forests through performance-based conservation fees.

It is predictably hard to protect forests facing the continent’s highest deforestation amount by landcover. However, the USAID/CFP developed systems that were locally appropriate and effective to mitigate these risks to forest carbon offset revenue generation.

2.2.1 SUPPORTING CRB ELECTIONS AND CAPACITY DEVELOPMENT

CRB elections are mandated at 3 year intervals through the 2015 Wildlife Act. At the beginning of the CFP most CRBs had not had elections for some years and were not functional due to the resources required to conduct transparent elections under the oversight of GRZ. USAID/CFP supported DNPW efforts to reestablish the CRBs in the project area with new elections. This brought fresh leadership to these groups and gave BCP the opportunity to assess current capacities. Based on those assessments BCP worked with DNPW to put together a training curriculum for CRBs that included a range of topics: good governance (transparency), financial management, gender, HIV, planning, Forest and Wildlife laws, CBNRM and climate change.

Most of the CRBs have gone through a second round of elections now and are showing improvements in governance, forest and financial management. BCP continues to provide mentoring support to all 12 CRBs. This is a long-term effort which is hampered by the 3 year CRB terms, and capacity issues at a community level. Risks which the CFP encountered and mitigated at a CRB level were related to elite capture, corruption, fraud, mismanagement of illegal materials, low capacity, sub-contractor mismanagement and nepotism.

Another key component of CRB capacity building was developed through the provision of conservation fees. This was an innovative way to both provide an incentive for forest conservation while building the CRBs capacity to manage income from CBNRM activities transparently and effectively.

Over \$360,000 were distributed to the CRBs in two separate annual payments. The payments were performance based. Initial payments were based on the number of hectares set aside for REDD+ at a rate of approximately \$0.20 per hectare (subject to the exchange rate). Subsequent payments were subject to penalties for loss of forest or other infractions. The CFP supported the CRBs and VAGs to carry out participatory planning approaches to identify the uses of the conservation fees, and support to build capacity to deliver projects to a good quality and in a timely fashion.

12 CRBs managing REDD+ areas.

\$369,617 in Conservation Fees managed.

2.2.2 SUPPORTING CONSERVATION LAW ENFORCEMENT

Ensuring conservation of forest and wildlife resources is a key requirement for biodiversity CCB gold verification. The CFP worked with CRB leadership to ensure community scouts are selected, trained, kitted, deployed and coordinated with DNPW to secure forest and wildlife assets. USAID/CFP funded advanced in service ‘Advanced Tactical Training’ of 30 community scouts selected and hired from partners Chiefdoms. Backed up by aerial monitoring CFP and the CRBs developed systems and communication protocols that allow them to react quickly to encroachment and other illegal activities in the project area. While 30 community scouts is too low for such a large area, these scouts are 30 above the previous baseline and are actively working under DNPW’s aegis to prevent forest loss and poaching.

19,146 conservation person days supported by the CFP.

33 Community Scouts supported by the CFP





2.3 PROVIDING DIRECT BENEFITS TO COMMUNITIES

Incentives are key to ensuring the long term buy in of neighboring communities to protecting REDD+ forests. The CFP provided multiple investment opportunities in communities in order to facilitate participation, provide alternative livelihoods and support long term community development efforts. It is important to understand that even though the CFP is coming to an end, the LCFP is just getting started and will be building on the benefits presented below for the next 30 years.

2.3.1 PARTNERSHIP IMPACT PROJECTS (PIPS)

PIPs were identified by communities early on in the CFP project. They were small infrastructure projects designed to kick off the relationship between BCP and the communities with a commitment to supporting local development. The purpose of PIPS was for the CFP to show intent and commitment to the process with communities.

Approximately \$8,000 was provided to each participating community in PIP funds, except for Luembe whose community forest area was around 190,000 hectares larger than the second largest community forest of 12. Luembe received a PIP pledge of \$20,000.

PIPs were a once-off joint project implementation effort. The PIP exercise provided valuable lessons to CFP and CRBs in the implementation of infrastructure projects.

Issues with quality control by third-party contractors led to sub-standard construction in some cases that had to be rectified. CFP's USAID-mandated water quality monitoring led to the discovery of arsenic and lead contamination in two bore holes provided under PIPs. Once discovered the GRZ was forced to step in and shut down access to those water points leading to increased scrutiny of water quality in the region.

Completed projects included:

- 6 Water points (boreholes and wells)
- 3 Transport related investments (Boat, bicycles, etc.).
- 2 Solar power installations.
- 1 health clinic investment (furniture).
- 1 IT investment.
- 2 Education investments.
- 6 Agricultural investments (treadle pumps, maize shellers, hammer mills).

24 PIP projects completed

4,535 Households Benefiting directly

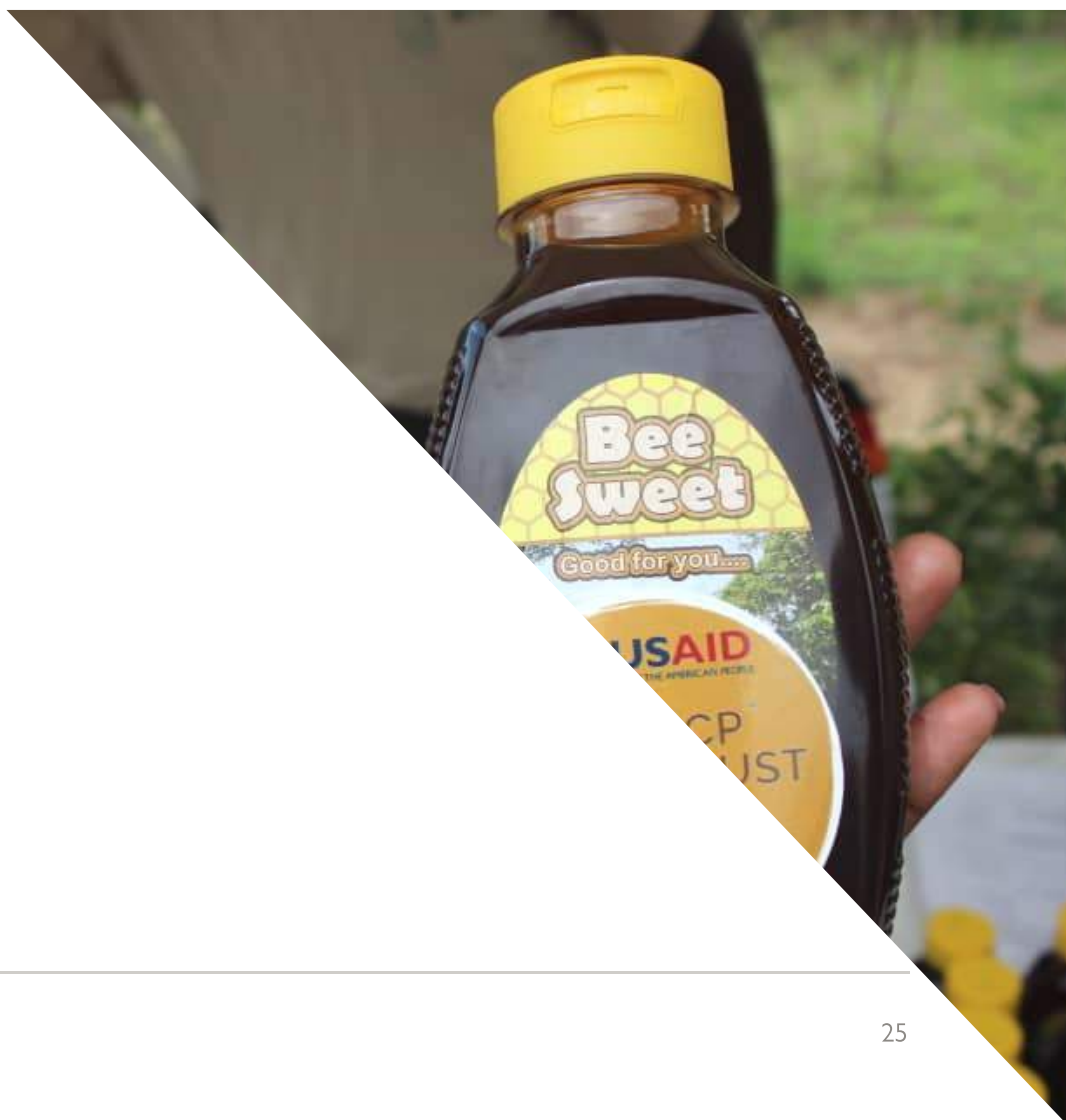
2.3.2 BEE SWEET HONEY INITIATIVE

Honey production is one of the key approaches employed through CFP to provide an alternative, scalable livelihood diversification option for off-farm income. The CFP entered into a partnership with Bee Sweet Ltd. (a honey aggregator and exporter) to provide hives, technical support and a market for honey produced VAG farmers. BCP sees this as a long term relationship that will benefit community members for years to come. It is also scalable and can be expanded easily in years to come, given the market for good quality honey. Harvests have been carried out in all areas of the project, and money flowing directly to farmers from an activity which adds yet another incentive to keep trees standing.

11,200 Hives Distributed

1,100 Households Benefitting







2.3.3 CONSERVATION FARMING TRAINING

Conservation farming techniques provide a suite of options for small scale farmers to increase production while reducing impacts on the land. These techniques reduce emissions while increasing resilience to climate related shocks (droughts and flooding).

The CFP put in place an innovative and cost-effective partnership with the Ministry of Agriculture to support GRZ extension agents to train lead farmers. The lead farmers then pass this training and knowledge on to “follower” farmers under this model.

While the CFP also experimented with linking conservation farmers to markets we saw limited success with the selected partners given the lack of infrastructure in many VAGs with direct impact on community forests. Rural markets tend to congregate around all-weather roads and market centers with more established rural farming communities. Communities on community forest boundaries are often newer or immigrant communities, or distant from roads, services and markets. Market outlets to keep their costs low tend to avoid penetration at such deep rural levels which means that CFP tended for focus on nutrition security and income diversification through honey for example.

110 lead farmers and **674** follower farmers trained



2.3.4 CONSERVATION FEES INVESTMENTS

As described above, conservation fees were paid to CRBs based on the number of hectares of forest set aside for REDD+ and subsequent performance in keeping those forests intact.

Conservation Fees were distributed to CRBs in 2017 and 2018. CFP provided close mentoring support to the CRBs as they developed and implemented plans for using these funds to further community development. Communities could program the funds in ways that did not contribute to deforestation and provided a benefit to a broad range of community members.

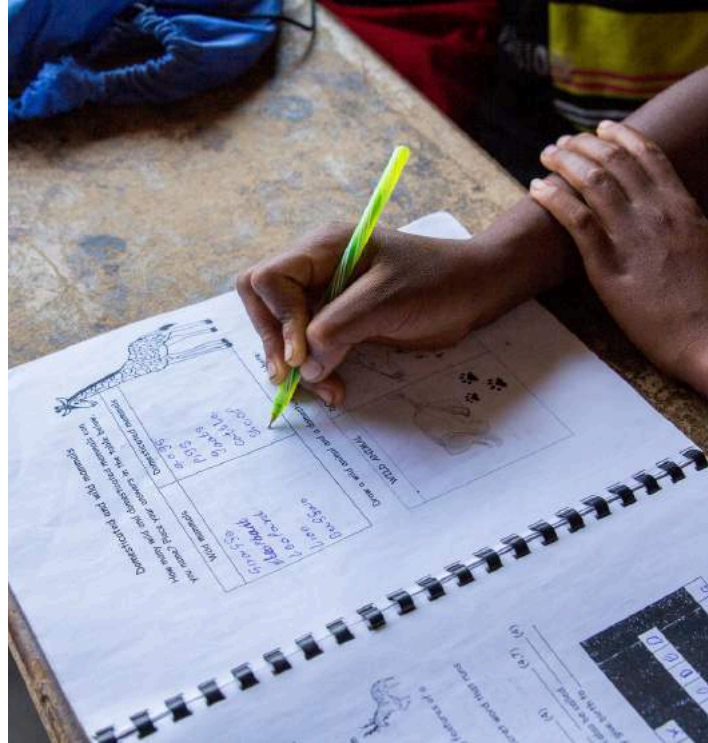
The overwhelming majority of projects went towards improving education infrastructure. Other projects supported agricultural development, health facilities, transport and water supplies.

23 Community Investments Made

2,227

Households Benefiting





2.4 REINFORCING THE LOWER ZAMBEZI REDD+ PROJECT (LZRP)

Incentives are key to ensuring the long term buy in of neighboring communities to protecting REDD+ forests. The CFP provided multiple investment opportunities in communities in order to facilitate participation, provide alternative livelihoods and support long term community development efforts. It is important to understand that even though the CFP is coming to an end, the LCFP is just getting started and will be building on the benefits presented below for the next 30 years.



2.4.1 SUPPORTING FOREST MONITORING AND VCS AUDITS OF THE LZRP

The LZRP undergoes a VCS audit every year in order to be able to issue VCUs for sale on the voluntary market.

The CFP supported an intensive forest monitoring regime that has resulted in 5 successful VCS audits and allowed CFP to develop a “live” monitoring system that is continuously updated by a field monitoring team using mobile technology.

In partnership with University of Oxford affiliated NGO Lion Landscapes, CFP also supported the development of a biodiversity monitoring system that is community-based and is being replicated throughout the CFP. The system uses distance sampling to monitor large ungulates, carnivores and Ground Hornbills (an IUCN-listed vulnerable species).

The results of these surveys show that a massive wildlife recovery is underway in the previously depleted LZRP with an approximate 100-300% increase in high conservation value species like sable and roan antelope.

5 Successful VCS Audits

Over **700,000** offsets VCS verified



2.4.2 IMPROVING CONSERVATION MANAGEMENT OF THE LZRP

Protection of forest and biodiversity resources is key to the success of the LZRP. The CFP supported 30 community scouts from the Mpanshya CRB to provide protection to Rufunsa Conservancy's REDD+ forest area, the adjoining Lower Zambezi National Park (LZNP), Mpanshya and Shikabeta community forests and the LZRP leakage belt in Chongwe District in coordination with DNPW.

The CFP provided improved communications (Radio systems), logistical support, equipment and training to the community scouts.

The CFP also supported Conservation Lower Zambezi (CLZ) with a \$150,000 grant to establish a Canine Detection Unit. The unit has been effective at reducing poaching in the area and wildlife trafficking and associated illegal activity in the Lower Zambezi Area Management Unit.

In addition, the CFP funded a major rehabilitation of Mukamba Gate (the main northern entrance to Lower Zambezi National Park). The CFP rehabilitated lodging and office buildings at the gate allowing the DNPW to post more GRZ personnel to this heavily threatened border of the Park, while providing additional protection to the LZRP. Mukamba Gate was also used as a basic and advanced training facility by the DNPW Training Unit, Conservation Outcomes and the Italian Government's Carabinieri Special Intervention Group (GIS) to build community scout capacity.

33 Community Scouts trained

36 poachers and illegal loggers apprehended

Canine Detection Unit established and active

19,146 patrol days achieved



2.4.3 PROVIDING COMMUNITY BENEFITS

The LZRP provided a great opportunity for the CFP to pilot different types of community benefits and incentives to encourage conservation.

While the LZRP was not technically a community based project (i.e. the REDD+ land was owned by a private land owner, not a community), it still required the engagement and participation of surrounding communities given that they were largely responsible for deforestation and poaching in the area.

The CFP supported the establishment of 4 community cooperatives to act as community institutions to manage the CFP partnership and benefits accruing from the LZRP as Bunda Bunda Chiefdom lacked a CRB. For most of the CFP duration, Bunda Bunda Chiefdom did not have a Chief which resulted in more land use allocation chaos in the absence of a Traditional Authority.

Revenue Shares and CFP infrastructure support.

Sales of VCUs resulted in \$140,000 in revenue being shared with these community cooperatives. The CFP directly supported construction of education (Teacher's house) and health (Chilimba Clinic) infrastructure as well as limited water point development (1 borehole).

Conservation fees from VCU revenue share mainly went to support water infrastructure, community teacher payments, hammer mills, maize shellers, and cooperative administration fees.

Support for conservation farming and bee keeping.

Through its partnership with the Ministry of Agriculture, the CFP supported the training of 20 lead farmers and 720 follower farmers in conservation agriculture.

The CFP supported the purchase and distribution of 5,000 bee hives to 500 households in the LZRP project area. Multiple harvests have taken place with Bee Sweet purchasing over 4.5 tons of honey from participants.

A follow up of a baseline survey conducted in 2012 by independent consultancy firm, Mint, illustrated that average household income in the LZRP project zone households increased by 4.5 times over 5 years (2012-2017) with much of this attribution to REDD+. In the same time period, household farming yields increased and dependence on illegal charcoaling decreased, and was no longer the dominant generator of household cash.

Eco-Charcoal Pilot Project

One of Zambia's main deforestation drivers is urban charcoal demand, mostly unlicensed and unsustainable. Any approach to deforestation mitigation in Zambia must address the need for urban cooking fuel.

As a means to pilot an intervention to address the need for charcoal, the CFP supported a scale up of a pilot Eco-Charcoal project. Using improved efficiency kilns from Senegal, locally developed sustainable forest management plans, innovative community incentive schemes, and paying taxes, Eco-Charcoal provides a legal, sustainable supply of quality lumpwood charcoal to urban markets, while generating rural producers more money from less labor.

The Eco-Charcoal brand is becoming well-known for quality and sustainability and approaching a target of 1% of Lusaka's annual charcoal demand (400 tons against Lusaka's 40,000 ton demand). Communities are managing 400 hectares of miombo woodland for Eco-charcoal through 85 trained charcoal entrepreneurs ('charpreneurs').

Eco-charcoal has the potential in time to spin off into its own scalable business with its own board targeting the other 99% of the illegal market and drawing in thousands of illegal producers into a charpreneur scheme.

Eco-Charcoal Pilot sustainably producing 144 tons per year







3. CFP INDEPENDENT EVALUATION SUMMARY

This section summarizes the conclusions of the USAID/Zambia funded independent evaluation of the CFP, completed in the final year of implementation. The evaluation was carried out by a team of experts fielded by Integra Government Services, LLC (Performance Evaluation of USAID/Zambia's Community Forests Program, January 2019). The objectives of the evaluation were:

- Document the overall effectiveness of the project in reducing deforestation of biologically significant forest landscapes;
- Identify lessons learned from the project—specifically, the strengths and weaknesses of the design and implementation of the CFP, and how they contributed to the project's successes and challenges; and
- Assess the sustainability of CFP results related to forestry conservation. That is, are the gains and successes of the CFP likely to continue after the end of the project?

Overall, the evaluation team concluded that the project was reducing deforestation and “that the CFP was successful in building the foundational layers of capacity necessary to manage REDD+ projects at the national and district levels, and to a limited extent, the local/village levels.”

The team felt that the CFP was “a groundbreaking project, because it was one of the first REDD+ projects funded by USAID to have forest carbon offsets verified and sold^[1], and one of the very few REDD+ projects implemented in a dry tropical forest. It was also groundbreaking because the implementing partner, BCP, was a private African-based company and not a traditional international development implementing partner.”

[1] Along with the BioREDD Project in Colombia and the TIST project in Kenya.

The following findings and lessons were presented in the evaluation report:

Capacity building for GRZ officials: CFP supported the GRZ in the writing of two national policies (statutory instruments) on managing carbon stocks and community forests. The evaluation team found strong evidence of capacity building around REDD+ throughout the GRZ.

Low levels of alternative livelihood training: BCP concentrated their forest conservation efforts, due to the carbon verification process and limited funds, more on carbon management than alternative livelihoods development. A quarter of FGDs reported not receiving any alternative livelihood trainings, including a third of the female-focused FGDs.

Community engagement: After a strong initial Free Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) process, the project reduced its engagement/sensitization at the community level over the long term. As a result, there was, and still is, confusion and misunderstanding about what the CFP is and what BCP does.

Financial uncertainties related to climate politics/markets: The essence of the CFP is to incentivize forest conservation by using funds generated from the sale of “forest carbon offsets” in climate change mitigation projects. The sustainability of this concept is dependent in part on the capacity and perseverance of BCP, and on the political mandate of national and local institutions involved with the project. However, the sustainability of the project is also dependent on the price of carbon – which in turn is dependent on how the world approaches the issue of climate change over the next five to ten years. This is obviously outside of the influence or control of BCP.

MANAGEMENT RESPONSE TO THE EVALUATION FINDINGS

In response to the team’s findings on alternative livelihoods and community engagement BCP management made the following statements:

- It is important to see BCP’s work in support of alternative livelihoods in light of the timescale of the REDD+ project. While it is true that budget limitations did reduce the projects ability to scale livelihoods interventions to the level we would have liked, our interventions will continue for 30 years. Well beyond the normal time scale of a USAID project. Because of this we think a more fair assessment of the CFP’s livelihoods reach will be seen further into the future.
- We are skeptical of the team’s findings on community engagement. The FPIC process involved over 18,000 people over a 2-3 year time period. The VCS audit, an exhaustive look at the extent of knowledge of the project by communities, found no such deficiency. It is possible that there was a flaw in the evaluations sampling scheme or some other misunderstanding in the way Focus Group Discussions were carried out. It shows the need for long-term consistent and repetitive engagement regarding the forest carbon projects.

That said, we appreciate greatly this independent evaluation of the project’s impact and confirmation of the accomplishments.



4. DETAILED CUMULATIVE ACHIEVEMENTS OF THE CFP

4.1 COMPONENT I - ZAMBIA INSTITUTIONAL AND COMMUNITY CAPACITY FOR REDD+ AND FORESTS MANAGEMENT INCREASED

Under this technical component, the CFP focused on building institutional (government) and community capacity to implement and monitor REDD+ projects in Zambia. It included activities and tasks that contributed to strengthening government capacity to develop policies and plans with stakeholders for REDD+ and LEDS (IR2.3.3).

Activities and tasks under this component are also intended to build the capacity of local organizations (CRB's) to implement REDD+ activities through learning-by-doing engagement and capacity building activities. This component works through three (3) major activities: capacity building of local institutions to promote local ownership and implementation of REDD+ activities; engagement with government stakeholders to encourage coordination of efforts, information sharing, and learning-by-doing; and support for the development of an enabling framework for REDD+ and CBNRM that promote local governance and sustainable forest management and conservation and is informed by stakeholder experience.

Output 1.1: Strengthened local governance capacity to support the development of REDD+ and community-based management of PFMAAs (IR 1.1)

This output was incredibly important to the CFP given the objective of achieving a community based REDD+ project capable of providing benefits and enduring for 30 years. Community Resource Boards (CRBs), local governments and traditional leaders are the back-bone of CBNRM efforts under the CFP.

CUMULATIVE ACHIEVEMENTS INCLUDE:

Highly effective communications materials translated in local languages and delivered to local communities as a means to help people understand REDD+, its benefits and obligations.

A very **effective community engagement team** capable of supporting the Free Prior and Informed Consent process needed to lay the groundwork for an effective REDD+ project. In addition the team continues to educate and inform communities about ongoing REDD+ activities and challenges.

Innovative “flying FPIC” process which builds community capacity to understand and visualize their forest resources using videos of and participation in overflights by community ambassadors. This has led to informed community decision making around REDD+ project boundaries in each chiefdom.

A decentralized **Chiefdom support staffing model** that ensures CRB’s get regular capacity building support from BCP.

Successful **capacity development of 12 Community Resource Boards (CRBs)** leading them through elections (in collaboration with government), capacity assessment, training in key skills areas (CBNRM, governance, financial management, etc.) and managing CBNRM benefits to deliver conservation results. The CFP also **provided key equipment** to support management capacity (data collection devices, computers, uniforms, camping gear).

INDICATORS OF INTEREST:

Outcome Indicator 5: Number of institutions with improved capacity to assess or address climate change risks supported by USG assistance.

Achievement

A total of 82 institutions have had improvements in their capacities to operate more efficiently and effectively. Of these 82, 8 are Government institutions such as the DNPW and FD. The CFP has also closely worked with the CRBs to provide good governance training and management of the REDD+ zones.

Comment: Capacity-building is intended to strengthen an organization's ability to provide quality and effective services, while also being viable.

Supporting an organization to be operationally sustainable (providing needed and effective services), as well as organizationally sustainable (with strong leadership and having necessary systems and procedures to manage by), while ensuring that it has sufficient resources (human, financial, and material) that are utilized well.

The CFP supported DNPW efforts to reestablish the CRBs in the project area with new elections. This brought fresh leadership to these groups and gave BCP the opportunity to assess current capacities. Based on those assessments, the BCP worked with DNPW to put together a training curriculum for CRBs that included a range of topics: good governance (transparency), financial management, gender, HIV, planning, Forest and Wildlife laws, CBNRM and climate change.

Most of the CRBs have gone through a second round of elections now and are showing improvements in independence, governance and management. BCP continues to provide mentoring support to all 12 CRBs.

CHALLENGES ENCOUNTERED:

CRB capacity was extremely low. Intensive support was needed to ensure they were able to manage conservation/forest protection activities. BCP dealt with this by providing direct mentoring and more direct control of CRB activities, particularly conservation.

Output 1.2 Improved capacity of government stakeholders to support the development and implementation of REDD+ activities and community-based management of PFMAs (IR 3.2)

The successful implementation of the CFP required supporting our government partners to be collaborative partners with the private sector and communities, and to create an enabling environment to implement community-based REDD+.

ACHIEVEMENTS INCLUDE:

BCP **established long term MOU's with DNPW and FD** to support REDD+ development and implementation.

Successful engagement with and **capacity development of government agencies** at all levels to collaboratively support REDD+ implementation. These include:

- FD at National, Provincial and District levels.
- DNPW at National, Provincial and District levels.
- District level government officers (Agriculture, DC's, development committees, etc).

Supporting the **development of two Regulations** to support an enabling environment for forest carbon projects.

Joint development of FPIC guidelines/process. Joint training in Participatory Rural Appraisal techniques to support the FPIC and forest selection processes.

Contributions to the development of the FREL and improvement of forest cover reference data sets.

Contributed to the World Bank funded Initiative for Sustainable Forest Landscapes (ISFL) project which was working to develop alternatives for jurisdictional monitoring and accounting for carbon in Eastern Province.

INDICATORS OF INTEREST:

Output Indicator 7: Number of laws, policies, regulations, or standards addressing climate change adaptation formally proposed, adopted, or implemented as supported by USG assistance

Achievement

The CFP accomplished a total of 17 laws, policies, regulations, or standards against a target of 36 measures. The 17 are disaggregated at Sub-National - Proposed = 14, National - proposed = 2 National Adopted= 1 .

Comment: The CFP worked with relevant stakeholders to collaborate on the development of the FPIC SOP, which was approved in draft form under the National REDD+ Program to CFP providing support towards the development of two Statutory Instruments (SIs) pertaining to forest carbon management and community forest management across the 12 chiefdoms.

Output Indicator 12: Number of public private partnerships (PPP) created to address climate change risks

Achievement

11 local and international partnerships were set up during the project period against a LOP target of 10. This translated into a 110% achievement against the target.

Comment The CFP was able to leverage its resources to reach out to partners and seize opportunities for collaborations with key GRZ entities such as Ministry of Chiefs and Traditional Affairs, DNPW, FD, EWSC, African Parks, Peace Parks Foundation, Game Rangers International, Conservation Lower Zambezi on the tracker dog unit, Bee Sweet, Lion Landscapes, Musika, Maliasili Initiatives, Luambe Conservation and the Luangwa Safaris Association.

CHALLENGES ENCOUNTERED:

GRZ suspicion of private sector companies is a challenge for BCP. However continuous dialogue and transparency in our efforts have gone a long way to building support for the CFP REDD+ efforts.

4.2 COMPONENT 2: FOREST MANAGEMENT AND CONSERVATION

The goal of the forest management and conservation component was to develop viable REDD+ models of community-based forest management that will lead to more sustainable forest management and conservation practices and reduced threats to biodiversity in target areas.

Activities within Component Two supported the development of community-based sustainable forest management using a REDD+ approach. This included the collection of data and information that was used to develop REDD+ agreements and plans and to verify carbon stocks for future market trading and benefit sharing. Critical associated activities include the development of outreach and awareness materials for communities to better understand REDD+ activities along with their rights and responsibilities; and the development of marketing materials to promote future credits generated at CFP sites.

INDICATORS OF INTEREST:

The CFP improved conservation management across 980,394 hectares. This includes the 40,000 hectares of LZRP which pre-date the CFP.

Lusaka Province constituted 203,000 hectares and Eastern Province 738,000 hectares. CFP thus delivered over 34% above the project's hectarage target. Of the 980,000 hectares, 79,000 was private, and the balance under customary control, or 901,000 ha.

This is Africa's largest REDD+ project by over 100,000 ha, and that it is on community lands is a major milestone globally.

Outcome Indicator 1: Number of hectares of biological significance and/or natural resources under improved natural resource management as a result of USG assistance.

PROVINCE	CHIEFDOM	DISTRICT	NAME	AREA (HA)
Eastern	Chitungulu	Lundazi	Chitungulu	38,741
	Jumbe	Mambwe	Jumbe	15,443
	Luembe	Nyimba	Luembe	289,600
	Malama	Mambwe	Malama	21,577
	Mnkhanya	Mambwe	Mnkhanya	33,623
	Msoro	Mambwe	Msoro	24,668
	Nyalugwe	Nyimba	Munyamadzi	18,650
	Mwanya	Lundazi	Mwanya	81,722
	Nsefu	Mambwe	Nsefu	39,801
	Nyalugwe	Nyimba	Nyalugwe	61,006
	Nyalugwe	Nyimba	Pia Madzi	20,541
	Sandwe	Petauke	Sandwe	92,367
Lusaka	Mpanshya	Rufunsa	Mpanshya	84,530
	Shikabeta	Rufunsa	Shikabeta	118,126
				940,394

Outcome Indicator 2: Greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions, estimated in metric tons of CO₂ equivalent, reduced, sequestered, or avoided through sustainable landscapes activities supported by USG assistance

Since inception, the CFP has sequestered 1,073,843 mtCO₂e against a target of 1,210,851 mtCO₂e.

Comment: These figures will be finalized after the completion of the LCFP VCS verification in 2019 as the auditor and VCS have final say.

Outcome Indicator 3: Projected greenhouse gas emissions reduced or avoided through 2030 from adopted laws, policies, regulations, or technologies related to sustainable landscapes supported by USG assistance

Achievement

This Indicator tracks projected emissions reductions over set periods of time. The projected targets are not anticipated to change over the rest of the lifetime of the CFP. Therefore, projected GHG emissions for 2017-2020 stands at 938,163 mtCO₂e (metric tons of carbon dioxide emissions).

Comment: These figures will be finalized after the completion of the LCFP VCS verification in 2019 as the auditor and VCS have final say.

Outcome Indicator 6: Number of people trained in sustainable landscapes supported by USG assistance

Achievement

1,490 people trained in sustainable landscapes disaggregated as 912 males and 578 females

Comment: CFP implemented sustainable landscape training for communities in conservation farming accounting for 987 farmers, 44 mentors in beekeeping, 87 people trained in sustainable charcoal production and various CRB governance and financial management trainings across the 12 chiefdoms.

Outcome Indicator 8: Number of people apprehended and/or arrested for violation of forest and/or wildlife laws and regulations in REDD+ zones

Achievement

36 people were apprehended for violating forest and/or wildlife laws in REDD+ zones

Comment: 57% reduction in violations across REDD+ zones from FY14-FY19. This is attributed to participatory forest management interventions and sensitizations by the community to protect the REDD+ zones.

Outcome Indicator 9: Number of illegally obtained forest and/or wildlife products/equipment seized in REDD+ zones

Achievement

332 illegally obtained forest and/or wildlife products pieces of equipment seized in REDD+ zones over the project period.

Comment: During the first 2 years (FY14 and FY15) of the project, the number of illegally obtained forest and/or wildlife product pieces of equipment seized in REDD+ zones increased, but as communities were sensitized and received benefits from protecting the REDD+ zones, an eventual reduction in the indicator of 38% was recorded over the life of the project. It is probable that the combination of community incentives, and investment in community scout employment and deployment contributed to deterrents to poach through improved livelihoods, more support for conservation, and a higher perception of the risks of poaching.

Outcome Indicator 10: Value of revenue from NRM disbursed to CBNRM institutions

Achievement

Over the Life of the project, the CFP has disbursed a total of \$369,617 in conservation fees, approximately \$140,000 in conservation fees from carbon offset sales in LZRP, plus \$92,000 in PIP projects. This total of \$601,617 against a target of \$340,000 was approximately 77% higher than the target.

Comment: In addition to the cash values above, the CFP benefited communities directly through job creation (approximately 60% of CFP's payroll) at project close out was community based. Investments into honey (approximately \$700,000) and conservation farming were not included in the calculation above. It is estimated that closer to \$2 million went into communities though not all of this passed through institutions.

Outcome Indicator 11: Amount of investment mobilized (in USD) for climate change as supported by USG assistance

Achievement

Over the project period, CFP mobilized \$2,263,755 for climate change adaptation activities distributed across private domestic, private international and Public domestic. This represents a 160% achievement against the target of \$1,400,000.

Comment: The CFP leveraged its local and international partnerships to achieve this target resulting in CFP being a \$16.2 million project.

Output Indicator 13: Number of carbon credits sold from REDD+ zones supported by USG assistance

Achievement

700,548 carbon credits sold over the project period.

Comment: 13% above the projected life of project target of 625,000 tonnes of carbon credits

Output 2.1 Forest sites (PFMAs) for project implementation identified and selected (linked to IR 2.1)

Considerable time and effort went into identifying and selecting REDD+ forest sites. Given the community focus it required the development of shared tools and methodologies that would ensure deep participation and consensus around land selection decisions.

ACHIEVEMENTS INCLUDE:

Development of a shared, Zambia REDD+ oriented, Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for Free Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC). This document was developed based on international FPIC guidelines and were refined with inputs from GRZ and Zambian Civil Society. This process was adopted by the CFP as our SOP for facilitating community agreements.

Training of GRZ and CFP staff in Participatory Learning and Action (PLA) and Participatory Rural Appraisal (PRA) tools and techniques. These skills were essential to implementing community engagement and the FPIC process with CFP communities.

Adoption of the innovative “flying FPIC” tool. This activity allowed the project to take community ambassadors on overflights of the proposed forest areas to help them communicate the extent of existing forests to their communities and to make better more informed decisions about how much forest to include under the REDD+ project.

REDD+ landcover maps completed with various layers and shared with partners.

Supported the **development of a Community Forest Management Agreement for use in REDD+ projects.** This was initiated through the REDD+ Working Group, and honed through a national stakeholder workshop held in Siavonga. Ultimately the CFMA adhered to the Community Forest Management SI. Key to these templates is that they are relatively simple binding documents that are not overly complicated to allow communities all levels to understand the agreements.

Supported a multi-disciplinary team of GRZ agents to **develop a Forest Carbon Management Statutory Instrument** that lays out the regulations for developing forest based carbon projects.

12 Community Forest Management Agreements were signed between communities and BCP with GRZ facilitation of the process.

11 of 12 Chiefdoms in the LCFP also benefitted from a joint GRZ and CFP approach to generate ‘Chiefdom Conservation Plans’ and ‘Forest Management Plans’

CHALLENGES ENCOUNTERED

Misinformation and misunderstanding. CFP was slowed down by 6 months in Nyimba District issues following allegations that CFP would suck oxygen out of the atmosphere, and inject trees with carbon causing mass tree and human die-offs.

A competitor's staff was alleged by communities to have caused these fears. An investigation was conducted and intensive work with leadership and communities to get them to understand REDD+ and trust the CFP. This shows the challenge of REDD+ projects working in the same area.

Evolving GRZ requirements for developing the CFP REDD+ project. REDD+ is a new mechanism and supporting the GRZ to participate effectively in its regulatory role required significant time, negotiations and capacity development.

Output 2.2 Improved data on greenhouse gas content (especially carbon) present in forest areas under different management regimes (IR 2.2)

While this is part of the process of developing any REDD+ project, activities under this output focused primarily on supporting the GRZ to develop land cover maps and improve the accuracy of the Forest Reference Emissions Level as a jurisdictional approach to REDD+.

ACHIEVEMENTS INCLUDE:

Updated greenhouse gas accounting systems for the LZRP on an annual basis leading to **5 successful VCS audits** and the **issuance of more than 700,000 Verified Carbon Units (VCUs)**.

Significant contributions to the FREL development to improve the accuracy of forest cover data in Eastern Province, in particular.

Development of a **live monitoring system for LZRP** that is updated by teams in the field with mobile technology (SMART).

Implementation of a **remote fire monitoring system** using MODIS to track fire in LZRP.

A **Breach Register established** to track deforestation events in CFP REDD+ areas.

MOUs established with CRBs to guide forest monitoring (patrol) activities. A minimum of 100 conservation patrol days per month targeted.

Creation of a spatially-explicit, relational database to support M&E and forest cover monitoring.

VCS audit carried out of CFP REDD+ project (the Luangwa Community Forests Project). Final audit results still pending, approval expected by September 2019.

CHALLENGES ENCOUNTERED:

Inaccuracies in the FREL made use of that tool problematic for the CFP. GRZ has been flexible in allowing BCP to propose other methodologies to deal with these issues in the VCS submission.

The CRB conservation patrols failed to achieve their intended impacts due to CRB capacity constraints. This model was discontinued in favor of a 'direct support model' which enables BCP to have hire/fire control over community scouts that the REDD+ project supports for improved accountability.

Lack of a concrete decision on how to account for forest carbon under a jurisdictional approach made decision making more complex. Allowances to grandfather in existing REDD+ projects once a jurisdictional approach has been agreed to will need to be negotiated.

Output 2.3 Strengthen Community-based Institutions in collaboration with other partners to manage project sites (IR 2.3)

To participate effectively communities must be organized into some sort of local, legally recognized institution and capacitated to manage forest resources and the benefits that flow from those resources. The CRBs were selected as the most appropriate community-based organizations to partner with BCP in the development of a community-based REDD+ project.

ACHIEVEMENTS INCLUDE:

The **creation of 4 cooperatives to act as village institutions for the LZRP**. No CRBs are active in Bunda Bunda Chiefdom so a different legal mechanism had to be found to organize these villages. A cooperative was found to be the most effective means and facilitated through Rufunsa District Council.

Mphanshya CRB provided community scouts to patrol the LZRP and the Northern border of the Lower Zambezi National Park and were part of a Project Steering Committee of LZRP.

CRB and VAG elections were organized for 12 Chiefdoms.

CRB capacity assessments and (in collaboration with DNPW) development and implementation of a training curriculum focused on **good governance, REDD+ management, financial management, and CBNRM**.

10 CRBs were approved by FD as Community Forest Management Groups (CFMGs). The CFP CRBs were among the first CRBs in Zambia to get this approval from GRZ. This was critical to moving towards REDD+ management agreements.

12 Community Forest Management Agreements and 2 Conservation Rights Covenants in place and covering the 30 year REDD+ project implementation period and 940,000 hectares.

CHALLENGES ENCOUNTERED

The process of getting CFMG recognition and approvals for the transfer of rights from Government to communities was complicated by the fact that it was the first time the regulations had been applied in Lusaka and Eastern Provinces and as such it was a learning process for GRZ officers, CRBs and the CFP.

Output 2.4 Improved Forest Management by the Community-based Institutions in cooperation with FD and ZAWA (IR 2.3)

Effective on the ground management of forest resources is essential to the success of a REDD+ project. The CFP worked to put in place the personnel and systems needed to ensure the long term protection of resources at the LZRP and CFP REDD+ sites.

ACHIEVEMENTS INCLUDE:

Capacity building of project staff in CBNRM through formal training and an exchange visit to Namibia. It was critical that the BCP team brought the latest best practice available to the implementation of the CFP.

63 Community Scouts employed and/or selected for basic training as of CFP close out.

Android **device based conservation monitoring system** (SMART) established for use by CFP supported teams.

A **biodiversity monitoring system** using distance sampling was established for the LZRP and Mnyamadzi Game Reserve as a pilot to monitor large ungulates, carnivores and ground hornbills in partnership with Lion Landscapes. The aim is to scale this system up into the wider CFP areas to monitor wildlife recoveries due to REDD+.

A **Mobile Dog Unit established** in the Lower Zambezi region to reinforce anti-poaching efforts in the area and reduce wildlife trafficking along the Great East Road. The CFP provided a grant of \$150,000 to Conservation Lower Zambezi (CLZ) to create the Dog Unit in partnership with the Department of National Parks and Wildlife.

A fire management plan developed and implemented for LZRP, as a pilot model for use under the LCFP.

Advanced Community Scout training was provided for 27 scouts through Conservation Outcomes and the Italian Carabinieri.

Lower Zambezi National Park's **Mukamba Gate infrastructure was refurbished** at a cost of approximately \$80,000 to enhance DNPW's ability to protect the north of Lower Zambezi National Park. Housing and office infrastructure was rehabilitated.

The Forestry Department Chinyunyu Station was partially refurbished.

Improved communications architecture for the LZRP. A radio repeater was procured and installed at the Rufunsa Site, with the effect of significantly improving communications for coordination on land management and forest monitoring, as well as team management and improved security and safety of staff.

Monthly mentoring support to CRB management teams to support conservation and community engagement efforts.

LZRP forest breaches reduced to zero in 2017 and 2018, showing the effectiveness of CFP interventions.

CHALLENGES ENCOUNTERED

Budget restrictions led to reduced joint patrols with DNPW to protect the Lower Zambezi National Park. Since REDD+ project focus on forest cover the CFP had to focus on that priority over anti-poaching although the intention of BCP is to provide both when resources permit.

Lack of quality control led to issues with construction that required remediation activities and special approvals from USAID to complete construction projects.

The Chinyunyu Forest Station had an asbestos roof installed before the CFP began. This complicated the refurbishment and added extra costs due to the sensitive nature of asbestos disposal and limited disposal facilities.

Output 2.5 Carbon credits from emissions reductions sold and benefiting local communities (IR 2.4)

It is the sale of carbon offsets that will fund the long term conservation of the CFP. The CFP invested in sales of VCUs by the LZRP and in the development of forward sales agreements for the LCFP. These sales will fund community development and management of REDD+ forests for the next 30 years.

ACHIEVEMENTS INCLUDE:

Developed **BCP website** for communication and sales (online purchase of VCUs).

Multi-year agreement for sale of LCFP and LZRP VCUs to European corporates.

Provided offsets to make the **Lower Zambezi National Park the first park in the world to be carbon neutral from its operations**. This was accomplished through purchases made by Lower Zambezi Tourism Operators.

Provided offsets to make **Luambe National Park the most carbon neutral park in the world**, thanks to offset purchases by Luambe Conservation. This effort covered not only operations but also all tourist activities in the park, including international flights.

700,548 VCUs sold under the LCFP (with partial CFP support).

CHALLENGES ENCOUNTERED

Considerable efforts were made to negotiate an investment by Althelia Climate Fund in the CFP (cost share). Ultimately the investment terms that Althelia offered were not conducive to supporting a long-term community-based REDD+ project and at the same time Althelia determined that it could not support a REDD+ project in a country where sport hunting occurred.

4.3 COMPONENT 3: COMMUNITY-BASED LIVELIHOODS

A key objective of the CFP is to identify and scale up sustainable community-based livelihoods and forest-based enterprises in order to support sustainable forest management activities and provide alternative livelihood options in the project area that reduce threats to biodiversity and conservation objectives. Ultimately, the difficulties in achieving the original cost share (\$4.5 million) led to the need to reduce some of the scale of the CFP's livelihoods program. That said, the CFP laid the groundwork for a 30-year program of community development that will be funded by carbon offsets.

INDICATORS OF INTEREST:

Outcome Indicator 4: Number of people receiving livelihood co-benefits (monetary or non-monetary) associated with the implementation of USG sustainable landscapes activities

Achievement

29,461 households (173,276 people) receiving livelihood co-benefits against a life of project target of 10,000 households, an increase of 195% above the LOP target.

Comment: 46% (80,263) are males and 54% (90,013) females that belong to 29,461 households of which 65% (19,191) are male headed households and 35% (10,270) are female headed households.

INTERMEDIATE RESULT 3.1: INCREASED NUMBER OF SUSTAINABLE ENTERPRISES IN TARGET AREAS

Output Indicator 14: Number of people linked to markets as a result of CFP-supported interventions

Achievement:

1,281 people linked to markets. 778 Males and 503 females, against a target of 2,200.

Comment: This was primarily achieved through a large honey pilot project of over 11,000 hives. As honey is not a BCP core business, CFP contracted Bee Sweet, one of Zambia's largest private honey companies as a partner, who also brought significant cost share and skills development to community-based mentors.

Output 3.1 Increased number of sustainable enterprises in target areas (IR 3.1)

ACHIEVEMENTS INCLUDE:

Household Registry showing **over 29,000 households in the project area, directly impacted by the CFP**. Due to unreliable census information, CFP arranged with GRZ to conduct a detailed household level census dataset by Chiefdom. This was an exhaustive multi-month exercise with the outcome of a spatial, accurate household registry.

The **Eco-Charcoal enterprise piloted in Rufunsa area continued to scale**, growing over 4 fold in community forests under improved and sustainable charcoal production. Eco-Charcoal storage facilities were constructed through CFP cost share (Musika), and a brand established that in time has the potential to spin off as its own business.

Follow-Up Social Monitoring Survey conducted for the LZRP (5 years after the 2012 baseline survey), **and project-specific Impact Evaluation Surveys** for 2 livelihoods activities (conservation farming and Eco-Charcoal) for the LZRP. Impacts found by the survey include the following:

- 75% (of 100 respondents) reported that they feel the CFP benefits their community
- 91% of households reported that they perceive direct benefits/inputs to their household from the project
- 75% of households reported active participation in the LZRP by a member of their household
- 79% reported understanding that the LZRP is a long-term project
- 91% reported understanding that the LZRP is taking place on the privately-titled Rufunsa Conservancy
- Conservation Farming participants: 85% reported higher yields; 88% reported more food for their families; 83% reported increased household income
- Eco-Charcoal: 99% would recommend to a friend Eco-Charcoal; 100% reported more income;

Conservation Farming training built capacity in 130 lead farmers trained who in turn have trained 1,394 follower farmers (in both CFP and LZRP sites). This intervention is important to increase nutrition security from smaller land footprints.

200 Ecozoom improved wood stoves distributed to communities in Rufunsa and Nyimba Districts.

CHALLENGES ENCOUNTERED:

Market linkages for farmers participating in conservation farming were difficult to establish in remote, rural areas and will require attention as the LCFP progresses.

Community based eco-tourism enterprises face viability challenges and barriers to entry in areas which are not high in wildlife and with a heavy infrastructure than investors are willing to risk capital in.

Reductions in cost share availability led to the CFP cutting back on livelihoods activities.

The village chicken project in Rufunsa proved to be unsustainable and ineffective as a means to reduce dependence on bush meat.

Output 3.2 Reduced threats to biodiversity linked to community development activities (IR 3.2)

ACHIEVEMENTS INCLUDE:

21 Partnership Impact Projects (PIPs) identified and implemented contributing to water, education, agricultural support, and health sectors.

Conservation Fee incentives designed to reinforce community commitment and build capacity of CRBs to manage funds transparently in the interest of the entire community.

Over \$300,000 distributed to LCFP CRBs in Conservation Fees and **\$86,000 distributed in revenue shares** to LZRP cooperatives.

A **'Risk-Mitigation Tool'** developed to help build community capacity in delivering community development projects. The tool guides communities through a self-help process of identifying all risks with a project, and mitigations designed to make a project sustainable, or make clear when a project is non-viable.

Community covenants were used as a tool to guide the investment partnership between communities and CFP and to ensure that projects do not have negative impacts on forests or biodiversity. Community covenants underscore the performance-based nature of REDD+ projects, and are an innovation that CFP helped to scale out.

CHALLENGES ENCOUNTERED:

Sub-contract management led to deficiencies in construction of PIPs that led USAID to issue a stop work order on construction until these deficiencies could be remediated. BCP was not intimately familiar with USAID construction rules, and as a result of the stop order built internal capacity to deliver quality construction.

3 boreholes had to be closed at the order of the GRZ and USAID due to lead and arsenic contamination.

Output 3.3 Increased information available to stakeholders concerning best practices, to improve effectiveness of forestry and related enterprises (IR 3.3)

While considerable training and information dissemination was included with all the above mentioned alternative livelihoods the CFP also supported an Environmental Education Program in the Rufunsa area as a pilot for activities that could be expanded to the larger LCFP. While funds did not allow for this expansion of activities during the CFP they could be added at a later date as funds become available.

ACHIEVEMENTS INCLUDE:

Support to coursework, **provision of environmental education materials, and facilitation of Special Environmental Education Days (SEEDs)**, as a means of raising environmental awareness (and interest) among students.

Teacher Salary Support Program (TSSP) implementation: Provides performance-based teacher **salary subsidies for teachers at community schools**, as a means of improving access to quality educational facilities at community schools (which do not receive GRZ support). A successful milestone is the graduation of these costs from CFP onto the community portion of the LZRP Conservation Fees. Communities now have their own revenues from forest conservation and chose to apply those to ensure their children have quality education.

CHALLENGES ENCOUNTERED:

Unfortunately, budgets did not allow for the expansion of the EEP to all CFP areas but lessons learned will be useful as funds become available for these kinds of activities.

Partnerships with institutions of higher learning were not realized due to budget limitations and implementation priorities.

5. COST ANALYSIS

While the CFP was not designed to provide detailed per unit cost analysis we are able to make some generalizations about the cost of developing community-based REDD+ projects and the potential return on investment from USAID/Zambia's investment in the CFP.



COMMUNITY-BASED REDD+ PROJECT

The total investment needed to achieve nearly 1 million hectares of community managed REDD+ under the CFP was approximately 16.5 million US Dollars (\$14 million from USAID and \$2.5 million in cost share).

Given the geography and accessibility of the areas where the project was established we believe that total budget would have been necessary for anywhere from 600,000 to 1.1 or 1.2 million hectares of REDD+ project. That gives a range of around \$14 to \$27 per hectare to create a community REDD+ project from scratch in Zambia.

It is important to note that a considerable amount of effort and budget was also expended on working with and building the capacity of GRZ to find the right path to an approved project. This would not be necessary in a subsequent REDD+ which suggests subsequent REDD+ investments in Zambia could be accomplished on the lower end of this range (around \$14 per hectare).

RETURN ON INVESTMENT FROM THE CFP

REDD+ projects have an effective life of at least 30 years. The LCFP, created under the CFP, is expected to run for 30 years generating on average around 1 VCU per hectare per year. This number can vary during the life of a REDD+ project and it will not be fixed until VCS Verification is completed in the coming months. At the same time the pricing of VCUs on the voluntary carbon market is also very volatile. The price BCP achieves for sales of VCUs from the LZRP varies greatly from as little as \$2 per ton to \$12, on average however LZRP VCUs attract a price of between \$4 and \$5. BCP expects a similar price point for LCFP VCUs at least for the first decade or so of the life of the project. This suggests that during the first 10 years of life the LCFP could generate \$4-5 million per year (\$40-50 million over 10 years).

No one knows what will happen to the price of carbon in the medium to long term. BCP's assumption is that it will increase, although it is very difficult to estimate by how much. But even if the price remains the same it means that an additional \$80-100 million dollars in revenue could be generated in the last 20 years of implementation. We believe at a minimum LCFP will generate \$120 - \$150 million dollars over the next 30 years. These funds will go towards managing REDD+ forests (protection, etc.) and the long-term development of the communities that manage these forests. In addition, they will help BCP to expand the development of new REDD+ projects.

USAID/Zambia's investment of \$14,000,000 in the CFP could return more than 10 times that amount over the next 30 years in REDD+ revenue; This will continue to ensure climate change mitigation, biodiversity conservation and the long-term development of rural communities in Zambia.



6. CROSSCUTTING ACTIVITIES

6.1 GENDER EQUALITY AND FEMALE EMPOWERMENT

BCP recognizes the importance of mainstreaming gender in the promotion of sustainable use and management of natural resources. Under the CFP BCP worked to ensure that women and men equally access, participate, and benefit from natural resource management, and that gender inequalities in activities and outcomes of its works are reduced or eliminated.

The above goal was implemented through:

1. Targeted activities to challenge gender stereotypes, support women to take up leadership roles in natural resource governance, and providing economic opportunities for women, through livelihood empowerment support and linkages to stable markets.
2. A gender responsive M&E system that helps the project to collect gender disaggregated data, track gender results, assess impacts as well as monitor access, participation, and benefits among males and females and incorporate remedial action that redresses any inequalities in project implementation.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS IN GENDER MAINSTREAMING INCLUDE:

Female headed households account for about 35% [10,270] of co-beneficiary households [29,461] in the project catchment area;

Females account for 52% [90,013] of project core beneficiaries [173,276];

Females account for 42% [416] of people [987] trained in conservation farming, empowered with sustainable economic activities and contributing to rural development. These women have further been linked to stable markets for the sustainability of their enterprises;

Females account for 14% [6] of people [44] trained in, and practicing bee-keeping, as a business, breaking the stereotypes that bee-keeping is a male economic activity, whilst reinforcing the incentives for forest conservation. These women have further been linked to stable markets for sustainability of their enterprises;

Females account for 19% [9] of people [69] trained in, and practicing sustainable charcoal production as a business, breaking the stereotypes that charcoal production is a male economic activity, whilst contributing to forest conservation.

The company employs 27 village scouts, a male dominated profession, of which 25% [5] are women.

6.2 SUSTAINABILITY MECHANISMS

The CFP was designed by USAID/Zambia with long term sustainability in mind. The Request for Applications for the CFP sought Implementing Partners that were prepared to make a multi-decade commitment to this project in Zambia. BCP was selected at least in part because it is an African social enterprise with a long-term commitment to conservation and community development in Zambia.

Verified Carbon Units certified for sale on the voluntary carbon market annually provide the long term finance needed to ensure sustainability of the project; both in terms of forest management funds and community incentives that drive long-term development of the area. In addition to a functional REDD+ project, the CFP had to invest in the following activities to ensure long term sustainability:

BCP capacity building was critical to the long-term success of the CFP. As an African social enterprise that had never managed USAID funding it was critical for the CFP to invest in BCP's capacity. In addition, adequate equipment and vehicle fleet were needed to ensure the ability of BCP to manage activities for the long term.

Community capacity building of the Community Resource Boards (CRBs). The CRBs are the legal entities charged with managing the REDD+ areas. The CFP worked to improve their governance and management capacity through training and mentoring. The Conservation Fees were distributed as a means to give the CRBs experience managing benefits from REDD+ in a transparent and fair manner.

GRZ capacity development and engagement. Without the GRZ it would be impossible to forward a REDD+ project in Zambia. The CFP invested in building expertise and support within the Forest Department, the Department of National Parks and Wildlife and the Ministry Of Chiefs and Traditional Authority. In addition, the CFP supported District level government to understand and engage effectively with the REDD+ project.



7. LESSONS LEARNED

Five years of implementation of the CFP has led to multiple lessons. The project was technically challenging in that REDD+ is a new sector and approach to conservation finance in a country that has had little experience with climate change mitigation. At the same time BCP is an African social enterprise with no real experience implementing large USAID projects and the administrative burden they carry with them.

Complicating this was the scale: close to 1 million ha of forest, in a total footprint of 2.2 million ha including community project zones. For that reason, we are dividing our lessons between technical and administrative.



TECHNICAL LESSONS AND CHALLENGES

CRB's lack capacity to drive conservation at a local level, needed direct support from BCP to develop capacities. BCP has had to use several different management / support models to find one that can ensure conservation impacts at a local level. CRBs in principle should have experience with fielding scouts and managing benefits from hunting revenue. But the fact is that these activities are often carried out by hunting concessionaires and directly by GRZ agents from DNPW. The CFP had to invest directly in CRB capacity development and provide direct mentoring in managing scouts and helping them manage conservation fees.

Government is not always ready to move at the same pace as BCP. Key GRZ partners, like the Forest Department, Department of National Parks and Wildlife and the Climate Change Secretariat have their own mandate and work within the confines of government bureaucracies. This sometimes limited their ability to support the CFP in ways that BCP felt would get the best result for REDD+ and the CFP. This often required the project to slow down and work through challenges with our GRZ partners to ensure we were working together for the same agreed outcomes.

Selection of REDD+ areas based on the potential return in carbon offsets as well as on community desires. The CFP used an extremely participatory and collaborative process to select REDD+ forests with the communities living around them. This is obviously a requirement of FPIC. That said, however, communities tended to choose forests for inclusion in REDD+ based on how far away they were from their current agricultural activities. Communities made a conscious decision to select forests that would not be threatened directly by deforestation for some years. This led to selecting areas, in some cases, with less inherent worth in terms of reducing deforestation and therefore less worth in terms of VCUs. It is critical that a REDD+ project take this into account and help communities to understand the potential for better financial returns from forests that are more threatened by deforestation.

Construction and water infrastructure works were challenging components of the CFP. BCP did not have a good understanding of how to manage construction and water works according to USAID standards. This led to issues with the quality of work and considerable time and effort remediating mistakes that were made in construction. For water, delays in getting water testing regimes in place meant that in a few cases contaminated water points were in use before the project became aware. These challenges led to difficulties in BCP's relationships with communities. It also however forced BCP to come up with improved protocols and procedures for helping communities to implement construction and water related projects.

Sales and marketing of carbon offsets at a price that will ensure sustainability. This is critical for the long-term survival of the LCFP REDD+ project. Investment in forward sales and having a good marketing mechanism in place before VCUs are approved is critical.

ADMINISTRATIVE LESSONS

Lack of capacity and experience with USAID administrative and financial requirements were a large challenge. Although BCP had Tetra Tech as a partner to support this area the two companies had trouble developing a system that could support the CFP at a reasonable cost. As the budget became tighter it became more and more difficult to use the Tetra Tech Sub-award. BCP hired administrative staff with experience managing USAID projects but the lack of a strong backstop, such as large traditional implementing partners have access to through overhead funding, led to difficulties in financial and administrative management controls. These difficulties were later resolved by engaging higher level expertise in these areas, particularly in financial management and M&E.

BCP was unable to source additional funds early on to cover the projected shortfall of \$4-5 million. This led to staff reductions and reduced funding for activities, particularly livelihoods.

SUPPORTING CRBS

Another set of lessons was documented around the process of supporting CRBs to use conservation fee proceeds to implement community development projects:

When budgets are announced, communities get very focused on spending the entire budget, sometimes at the expense / instead of focusing on delivering the most critical needs that were identified. As such, in designing our model for the distribution of Conservation Fees through community institutions, in future, our team is now aware that we will need to balance the undisputed need for transparency on financial amounts available, against the desire to avoid distractions based on the amount of funding available, and the need to encourage focus on the delivery of critical community development needs;

It is critical that our teams present themselves as supporters to community-led decision-making and delivery of community projects. It is important that we promote models that encourage the accountability of local institutions to their constituents, whose interests they are supposed to represent;

Commitments to projects should only be made once budgets have been confirmed; and communities must understand that these budgets are fixed and they need to work within them.

Communities need help ensuring that district engineers are involved in setting up and monitoring infrastructure projects to avoid construction deficiencies.

Involving appropriate District GRZ representatives is critical for all community projects (health, Agriculture, water, planning, and education).

ANNEXES

ANNEX A: CFP CUMULATIVE PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

The indicator performance tracking table below outlines the progress against the 15 CFP indicators across the LOP of 5 years, FY18 to FY19 Quarter I. Disaggregation is provided where possible to give clarity on indicators.

PROGRESS ON INDICATORS

This section provides background information and explanations of results reported in the IPTT, which is included in Section 2 of this document. Below is the narrative of progress made on each program indicator, followed by the program Results Table.

Indicator 1: Number of hectares of biological significance and/or natural resources under improved natural resource management as a result of USG assistance

The cumulative total to 959,291 hectares of community forests in Rufunsa, Nyimba, Mambwe, Petauke and Lundazi districts in Lusaka and Eastern provinces, under improved management. The table below gives the distribution of the cumulative total hectares brought under improved natural resource management across the project sites and chiefdoms:

DISTRICT	CHIEFDOM	AREA (HA)
Rufunsa District	Mpanshya	84,663
Rufunsa District	Shikabeta	115,353
Lundazi District	Mwanya	87,784
Nyimba District	Luembe	289,934
Nyimba District	Nyalugwe	61,088
Mambwe District	Msoro	24,089
Mambwe District	Malama	32,297
Mambwe District	Mnkhanya	33,608
Mambwe District	Jumbe	16,212
Mambwe District	Nsefu	39,779
Lundazi District	Chitungulu	39,509
Petauke District	Sandwe	92,544
Nyimba District	Luembe	18,871
Nyimba District	Nyalugwe	20,560
		959,291

Indicator 2: Greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions, estimated in metric tons of CO₂ equivalent, reduced, sequestered, or avoided through sustainable landscapes activities supported by USG assistance

Reducing, sequestering or avoiding GHG emissions has the capacity to slow down the rate of climate change, thus reducing the impacts to be felt by communities. Since inception, the CFP has sequestered 1,073,843 mtCO₂e against a target of 1,210,851 mtCO₂e. These figures will be finalized after the completion of the LCFP VCS verification in 2019 as the auditor and VCS have final say.

Indicator 3: Projected greenhouse gas emissions reduced or avoided through 2030 from adopted laws, policies, regulations, or technologies related to sustainable landscapes supported by USG assistance

This Indicator tracks projected emissions reductions over set periods of time, the projected targets are not anticipated to change over the rest of the lifetime of the CFP. Therefore, projected GHG emissions for 2017-2020 stands at 938,163 mtCO₂e (metric tons of carbon dioxide emissions). This implied that for the set period of upto 2030, projected estimate is 4,065,373mtCO₂e.

Indicator 4: Number of people receiving livelihood co-benefits (monetary or non-monetary) associated with the implementation of USG sustainable landscapes activities

The cumulative co-beneficiaries stand at 173,276 (80,263 Males: 93,013 Females) people in 29,461 (10,286 Female headed: 19,175 Male headed) households. This exceeds the EOP target of 20,000 people by more than 500%. The table below gives the distribution of people receiving livelihood co-benefits during the Lop period across the project sites and chiefdoms (B = beneficiaries; HH= households):

SITE	CHIEFDOM	TOTAL B	# MALE B	# FEMALE B	TOTAL HH	# MALE HH	# FEMALE HH
Mfuwe	Nsefu	7,264	3,470	3,794	1,369	941	428
	Jumbe	15,962	7,938	8,024	2,902	1,697	1,205
	Mnkhanya	20,583	10,199	10,384	3,636	2,262	1,374
	Msoro	17,310	8,549	8,761	3,322	2,354	968
	Malama	840	418	422	165	91	74
	Mwanya	5,564	2,710	2,854	1,055	737	318
	Sandwe	60,102	25,243	34,859	9,391	6,104	3,287
	Chitungulu	10,880	4,570	6,310	1,700	1105	595
Nyimba	Luembe	10,654	5247	5407	1,921	1,134	787
	Nyalugwe	4,803	2,422	2,381	890	632	258
Rufunsa Expansion	Mpanshya	10,002	4,877	5,125	1,594	907	687
	Shikabeta	2,009	1,011	998	319	200	119
Rufunsa Pilot	Bunda-Bunda	7,303	3,609	3,694	1,197	1,011	186
TOTAL		173,276	80,263	93,013	29,461	19,175	10,286

Indicator 5: Number of institutions with improved capacity to assess or address climate change risks supported by USG assistance

CFP decided to drop this indicator in FY 18 as the CRB's had reached the end of their mandates and were dissolved. This made it impossible to conduct a post institutional capacity assessment survey before the end of the CFP. However, a total of 82 institutions have had improvements in their capacities to operate more efficiently and effectively. Of these 82, 8 are Government institutions that include DNPW and FD. The CFP has also closely worked with the CRBs to provide good governance training and management of the REDD+ zones.

Supporting an organization to be operationally sustainable (providing needed and effective services), as well as organizationally sustainable (with strong leadership and having necessary systems and procedures to manage by), while ensuring that it has sufficient resources (human, financial, and material) that are utilized well. The CFP supported DNPW efforts to reestablish the CRBs in the project area with new elections. This brought fresh leadership to these groups and gave BCP the opportunity to assess current capacities. Based on those assessments BCP worked with DNPW to put together a training curriculum for CRBs that included a range of topics: good governance (transparency), financial management, gender, HIV, planning, Forest and Wildlife laws, CBNRM and climate change. Most of the CRBs have gone through a second round of elections now and are showing improvements in independence, governance and management. BCP continues to provide mentoring support to all 12 CRBs.

Indicator 6: Number of people trained in sustainable landscapes supported by USG assistance

The total number of people trained in sustainable landscapes during the life of the project stands 1490 People disaggregated between males M-912 and Females F-578.

Indicator 7: Number of laws, policies, regulations, or standards addressing climate change adaptation formally proposed, adopted, or implemented as supported by USG assistance

The cumulative total is 17 statutory instruments passed against the EOP target of 36. The disaggregation is further laid out in the indicator performance tracking table. The CFP worked with relevant stakeholders to collaborate on the development of the FPIC SOP, which was approved in draft form under the National REDD+ Program to CFP providing support towards the development of two Statutory Instruments (SIs) pertaining to forest carbon management and community forest management across the 12 chiefdoms.

Indicator 8: Number of people apprehended and/or arrested for violation of forest and/or wildlife laws and regulations in REDD+ implementation zones

The Number of people apprehended and/or arrested reduced by 57% at the end of the project period. Accounting for this is thorough community sensitization on benefits of protecting the redd+ zones. Further, adequate security patrols to curb violations added to the reduction in this indicator. The cumulative total since inception currently stands at 36 with 35 males and 1 female.

Indicator 9: Number of illegally obtained forest and/or wildlife products/equipment seized in REDD+ implementation zones

Overall progress on this indicator has been increasing at a decreasing rate. Due to effective management of REDD+ zones through improved capacities, this indicator has been declining since start of the project on a yearly basis at an overall rate of 38% over the project period. Cumulative total incidents recorded under this indicator is 332. During the first 2 years (FY14 and FY15) of the project, the number of illegally obtained forest and/or wildlife product pieces of equipment seized in REDD+ zones increased, but as communities were sensitized and received benefits from protecting the REDD+ zones, an eventual reduction in the indicator of 38% was recorded over the life of the project. It is probable that the combination of community incentives, and investment in community scout employment and deployment contributed to deterrents to poach through improved livelihoods, more support for conservation, and a higher perception of the risks of poaching.

Indicator 10: Value of revenue from NRM disbursed to CBNRM institutions

In terms of achieving the CFP EOP target for this indicator, CFP has disbursed a total \$369,617 against a target of \$340,000 to CBNRM institutions representing a 9 % achievement against the target.

Indicator 11: Amount of investment mobilized (in USD) for climate change adaptation as supported by USG assistance

CFP has mobilized a total amount of \$2,352,098.48 for climate change adaptation.

Indicator 12: Number of public private partnerships (PPP) created

11 local and international partnerships were set up during the project period against a LOP target of 10. This translated into a 110% achievement against the target. The CFP was able to leverage its resources to reach out to partners and seize opportunities for collaborations with key GRZ entities such as Ministry of Chiefs and Traditional Affairs, DNPW, FD, EWSC, African Parks, Peace Parks Foundation, Game Rangers International, Conservation Lower Zambezi on the tracker dog unit, Bee Sweet, Lion Landscapes, Musika, MaliAsili Initiatives, Luambe Conservation and the Luangwa Safaris Association.

Indicator 13: Number of carbon credits sold

CFP initiated preparations to sell carbon in both LCFP and LZRP. To date, the LZRP (supported by the CFP) has sold a total of 700,548 offsets, against the overall EOP target of 625,000 credits, to a variety of domestic and international buyers.

Indicator 14: Number of people linked to markets as a result of USG supported interventions

Linking local producers to available markets for inputs and sale of their products is another avenue through which the CFP is directly empowering local communities and populations with sustainable, alternative livelihood opportunities. In terms of achieving the CFP EOP target for this indicator, CFP has linked a total 1,281 (M-778F-503) people to markets against a target of 2,200.

Indicator 15: Number of educational, healthcare, water supply and other socio-economic infrastructure works constructed and/or refurbished in REDD+ zones with USG support

During the Lop, completed partnership impact infrastructural projects stands at a cumulative total to 24 against the CFP EOP target of 35. As part of the empowerment process, communities went through a participatory project selection process and almost always opted for communal projects. Many community members viewed these as indirect benefits which makes the perception of value creation from the REDD+ zones less relevant than direct benefits, such as employment or bee hives.

INDICATOR PERFORMANCE TRACKING TABLE

S/N	Indicator Classification	Objectively Verifiable Indicator	Indicator Disaggregation and Unit of Measurement	Data Source(s)	FY15 Actual	FY16 Actual	FY17 Actual	FY18 Actual	FY19 Actual	EOP Target	LOP Achievement
1	G 4.8.1-26 <u>Frequency:</u> Quarterly /Annually	Number of hectares of biological significance and/or natural resources under improved natural resource management as a result of USG assistance CFP; # hectares under improved management through REDD+	<u>Unit of Measurement:</u> Hectares <u>Disaggregation:</u> - Land Type (e.g.: private land, community land / GMA)	Technical Outcome (tracker + supporting documentation): REDD+ Implementation Consent/ Agreement letters or documents containing maps and/or geospatial (GIS) information	9,000 (private)	234,260 (community – new) + 39,000 (private – continuing)	514,438 (community – new) / 748,698 (community – cumulative) 39,000 (private - cumulative/ ongoing)	92, 544 new (community)	0 new 998,291 (959,291 community – cumulative) 39,000 (private - cumulative/ ongoing)	700,000 hectares (cumulative)	959,291 (community) + 39,000 (private)
2	EG.13-6 <u>Frequency:</u> Annually	Greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions, estimated in metric tons of CO2 equivalent, reduced, sequestered, or avoided through sustainable landscapes activities supported by USG assistance	<u>Unit of Measurement:</u> Metric tons of CO2 equivalent (tCO2e) <u>Disaggregation:</u> N/A	Technical Outcome (tracker + supporting documentation): USAID AFOLU Carbon calculator tool (pre-verification); VCS methodology (post-verification).	0	172,571	399,045 (new) / 571,616 (cumulative)	502,227 (new)	N/A	1,210,851 mtCO2e (cumulative)	1,073,843
3	EG.13-7 <u>Frequency:</u> Annually	Projected greenhouse gas emissions reduced or avoided through 2030 from adopted laws, policies, regulations, or technologies related to sustainable landscapes as supported by USG assistance	<u>Unit of Measurement:</u> Metric tons of CO2 equivalent (tCO2e) <u>Disaggregation:</u> Years under consideration	Technical Outcome (tracker + supporting documentation): USAID AFOLU Carbon calculator tool				938,163 tCO2e	N/A	Year of adoption through 2020 (2017-2020): 938,163 2021 through 2025: 1,399,170 2026 through 2030: 1,650,800	938,163 tCO2e
4	EG.13-5 <u>Frequency:</u> Quarterly /Annually	Number of people receiving livelihood co-benefits (monetary or non-monetary) associated with the implementation of USG sustainable landscapes activities	<u>Unit of Measurement:</u> Number of people <u>Disaggregation:</u> - Gender - Households	Participation Registry / Database: Household Stakeholder Beneficiary Registry	0(new)	67,523 new people - (33284 males and 34239 females) 12,449 (new) households	90,048 people - cumulative (44,379 males and 45,669 females) 16,208 households - cumulative (10,710 male HHs and 5,498 female HHs)	83,227 New people (35,884 males and 47,344 females) 13,253 new households	0 New people 0 new households 173,276 people - cumulative (80,263 males and 90,013 females) 29,461 households - cumulative (19,191 male HHs and 10,270 female HHs)	20,000 people (cumulative)	
5	EG.13-2 <u>Frequency:</u> Quarterly /Annually	Number of institutions with improved capacity to assess or address climate change risks supported by USG assistance	<u>Unit of Measurement:</u> Number of institutions <u>Disaggregation:</u> National Sub-national governmental, Other	Hybrid – Participation + Technical Outcome: CFP Program Activity Records (clearly listing institutional participation)	7 (new) Government/ sub-national	4 (new)Other /sub-national /11 (cumulative)7 Government/sub-national; 4 other/ sub-national	82 (cumulative) 8 Government/subnational; 74 other/ sub-national	173,276 people - cumulative (80,263 males and 90,013 females) 29,461 households - cumulative (19,191 male HHs and 10,270 female HHs)	0 new /0 (cumulative) 8 Government/subnational; 74 other/ sub	93 institutions (cumulative)	0 Government/subnational; 0 other/ sub-nation
6	EG.13-1 <u>Frequency:</u> Quarterly /Annually	Number of people trained in sustainable landscapes supported by USG assistance	<u>Unit of Measurement:</u> Number of people <u>Disaggregation:</u> Gender	Participation Registry / Database: CFP Program Activity Records (training records + attendance sheets)	40 (new) M-30 F-10	214 (new) M-149 F-65 254 (cumulative)	785 (New) M-461 F-346 1039 (cumulative)	451 new 1489 (cumulative)	0 new 1490 People (cumulative)	1,500 people (cumulative)	1490 People M-912 F-578
7	EG.13-3 <u>Frequency:</u> Quarterly /Annually	Number of laws, policies, regulations, or standards addressing climate change adaptation formally proposed, adopted, or implemented as supported by USG assistance	<u>Unit of Measurement:</u> Number of measures <u>Disaggregation:</u> - National, proposed - National, adopted - national, Implemented - Sub-national, Proposed - Sub-national, Adopted - Sub-national, Implemented -Regional/International, Proposed -Regional/International, Adopted -Regional/International, Implemented	Technical Outcome (tracker + supporting documentation): Copies of measures + narrative / supporting documentation confirming status	0	6 new Sub-National - Proposed = 6	6 new / Sub-National - Proposed =4 National - proposed = 2 12 (cumulative) National - proposed = 2 Sub-National - Proposed = 10	1 new / National, Adopted	0 new / National, Adopted 17 (cumulative) Sub-National - Proposed =14 National - proposed = 2 National Adopted= 1	36 measures (cumulative)	17 (cumulative) Sub-National - Proposed =14 National - proposed = 2 National Adopted= 1
8	Custom <u>Frequency:</u> Quarterly /Annually	Number of people apprehended and/or arrested for violation of forest and/or wildlife laws and regulations in REDD+ zones	<u>Unit of Measurement:</u> Number of people <u>Disaggregation:</u> Gender; Type of Offence (e.g. Forest or Wildlife Offences)	Technical Outcome (tracker + supporting documentation): Incident Reports → Conservation Tracker	7(new) 7 M)/Wildlife offence	12 (new)/Males/Wildlife offence 19 (cumulative)Males/ Wildlife offence	13 (new) (12 M:1F) Wildlife offence 32 (cumulative)(31M:1F)Wildlife offence	4(4M:0F)/ (new)	0 (new) 36(cumulative) (35M:1F)Wild life offence	0 / N/A (no target for number of people arrested)	36 (cumulative) (35M:1F)Wildlife offence
9	Custom <u>Frequency:</u> Quarterly /Annually	Number of illegally obtained forest and/or wildlife products/ equipment confiscated in REDD+ zones	<u>Unit of Measurement:</u> Number of items <u>Disaggregation:</u> Type of illegal items confiscated	Technical Outcome (tracker + supporting documentation): Incident Reports → Conservation Tracker	26 (new) (7 guns, 19 ammunition)	159 (new) 185 (cumulative)	131 (new) 316 (cumulative)	16 new	0 new 332 cumulative	0 / N/A (no target for number of items confiscated)	332 cumulative

S/N	Indicator Classification	Objectively Verifiable Indicator	Indicator Disaggregation and Unit of Measurement	Data Source(s)	FY15 Actual	FY16 Actual	FY17 Actual	FY18 Actual	FY19 Actual	EOP Target	LOP Achievement
10	Custom <u>Frequency:</u> Quarterly /Annually	Value of revenue from NRM disbursed to CBNRM institutions	<u>Unit of Measurement:</u> U.S. Dollars <u>Disaggregation:</u> N/A (REDD+ Project and Chiefdom)	Technical Outcome (tracker + supporting documentation): Proof-of-Payment; Receipts; Financial Records; Commitment Letters	0	\$60,000	\$176,000 (new) / \$236,000 (cumulative)	\$91,054 (new) \$327,060 (cumulative)	\$42,557(new) \$369,617 (cumulative)	\$340,000 USD (cumulative)	\$369,617
11	EG 13-4 <u>Frequency:</u> Quarterly /Annually	Amount of investment mobilized (in USD) for climate change as supported by USG assistance	<u>Unit of Measurement:</u> U.S. Dollars <u>Disaggregation:</u> - Public, domestic - Public, international - Private, domestic - Private, international	Technical Outcome (tracker + supporting documentation): Financial Records of funds mobilized and received	0	\$142,350 \$78,500/Private, domestic \$63,850/Private international	\$292,450 \$277, 250 /Private domestic \$2,700 Public, domestic \$12,500 private international	\$108,951 new Private domestic	\$72,766	\$1.4 million USD (cumulative)	\$638,957.23 \$500,956 Private domestic 135,301 private international \$2,700 Public, domestic
12	Custom <u>Frequency:</u> Quarterly /Annually	Number of public private partnerships (PPP) created	<u>Unit of Measurement:</u> Number of PPPs <u>Disaggregation:</u> N/A	Technical Outcome (tracker + supporting documentation): Records of MoUs / Agreements Signed.	4 (changed from 3)	5	1 new / 10 (cumulative)	1 new	0 new 11 cumulative	10 PPPs	11
13	Custom <u>Frequency:</u> Quarterly /Annually	Number of carbon credits sold	<u>Unit of Measurement:</u> Number of credits sold <u>Disaggregation:</u> N/A	Technical Outcome (tracker + supporting documentation): Sales records (and can be additionally confirmed by VCS database)	195,024 (new)	152,328 (new)	167,710 (new)	189,879 new	0 new	625,000	705,141
14	Custom <u>Frequency:</u> Quarterly /Annually	Number of people linked to markets as a result of CFP-supported interventions	<u>Unit of Measurement:</u> Number of people <u>Disaggregation:</u> Gender	Participation Registry / Database: CFP Program Activity Records (participation records) + MOUs / agreements confirming market linkages	6 (new) M-6 F-0	18 (new) M-18 F-0 24 (cumulative)	1237 (new) 1261 (cumulative)	20 (new) 1281(cumulative)	0 (new) 1281(cumulative)	2,200 People (cumulative)	1281 People M-778 F-503
15	Custom <u>Frequency:</u> Quarterly /Annually	Number of educational, healthcare, water supply and other socio-economic infrastructure works constructed and/or refurbished in REDD+ zones with USG support	<u>Unit of Measurement:</u> Number of infrastructure completed <u>Disaggregation:</u> N/A	Technical Outcome (tracker + supporting documentation): Completion Reports	6 (new)	3 (new) / 9 (cumulative)	8(new) 17 (cumulative)	1(new)	6(new) 24 cumulative	35 new infrastructure	24

ANNEX B: FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT

Community Forests Program Budget below represents a summary of the expenditure incurred through implementation of the project for the period February 2014 to January 2019.

CATEGORY	PROJECTED BUDGET (ZMK)	TOTAL EXPENDITURE (ZMK)	%
Personnel	36,402,258	45,743,717	126%
Fringe Benefits	8,132,865	6,282,012	77%
Travel	6,150,716	7,481,323	122%
Equipment	19,011,126	11,345,336	60%
Sub-Awards	20,891,004	17,481,699	84%
Construction	7,789,308	1,119,280	14%
Other Direct Costs	31,574,569	37,033,606	117%
TOTALS	129,951,847	126,486,973	97%

Projected Budget = obligated funds to date

NOTE: the above figures are provisional until confirmed through the independent audit verification.



PAINTING FOR PROTECTION: CFP & COMMUNITY PAINT THREATENED FOREST IN MSORO CHIEFDOM

In August, representatives from the USAID-funded Community Forests Program (CFP) joined with local leaders and “Ambassadors” from Msoro Chiefdom, to paint 2.6 km along the Chiefdom’s proposed Conservation Forest boundary. Msoro Chiefdom was selected as the first site to pilot visible demarcations. The community had already warned that certain areas of the proposed Conservation Forest are very close to villages, and flagged these areas as “high risk” for the clearing of trees along the proposed boundary.

The day long activity involved 21 people, and was a training opportunity to visibly mark the most threatened areas of their proposed Conservation Forest boundaries.

This is an important next step in the efforts of the CFP, which has been engaging with local community leaders, Government, and rural community stakeholders, since 2014, to identify local areas of community forest for conservation using the REDD+ methodology. The fact that local communities are now ready and willing to begin visibly marking their proposed boundaries for forest protection, is a major milestone for the CFP!



This pilot also provided an important reminder of the threat that these forests face. From pressures to clear trees for agricultural expansion, and to make space for a rapidly growing population.

Sure enough, the community members were right: participants in the painting activity witnessed a 'new' village (i.e.: it was only started within the past few months) just along the boundary of the proposed protected forest area. Near to this village, the team saw numerous trees that had been felled, presumably to allow for agricultural expansion. They also saw trees that had been 'ring-barked', which is a practice that slowly kills trees, when the bark is removed, by preventing nutrient flow. In some cases, trees had been deliberately ring-barked, to make them easier to knock down and clear for agricultural expansion. However, in one case, the trees had been stripped of their bark in order to make hives for honey production, using an unsustainable method.

The painting activity provided an opportunity for Community Ambassadors to speak with residents of the local village, reminding them of the proposed REDD+ Conservation Forest boundary, and encouraging them to participate in the sustainable livelihoods activities that will be implemented by the CFP in their Chiefdom. Importantly, the initial boundary painting activity provided a learning opportunity for the implementing partners of the CFP, who have committed to help local communities in 7 participating Chiefdoms at the Mfuwe Site in upcoming months to visibly mark the “most threatened” areas of their Conservation Forest boundaries, to ensure local community awareness of the boundaries, and to avoid conflicts based on misunderstandings, in the future. As of October 2016 over 200 kilometres of boundaries have been demarcated in the seven chiefdoms. Wildlife Police Officers (WPOs) from the local DNPW offices were involved in all of these activities, and activities will continue to proceed with GRZ involvement and support.

These initial boundary marking activities are expected to be followed by a more formal boundary demarcation process, which will be undertaken in upcoming months, under the direction of, and in full partnership with the Government of Zambia, including the Department of National Parks and Wildlife (DNPW), which is the Government Department responsible for the management of Game Management Areas (GMAs) where the Conservation Forests are located.



Representatives from the CFP and Msoro Chiefdom painted 2.6 km along a “high threat” boundary of the proposed Msoro Chiefdom Conservation forest



NEW PARTNERSHIP WITH BEE SWEET EXPANDS HONEY PRODUCTION TO SUPPORT CONSERVATION

The Community Forests Program (CFP) is proud to announce a new partnership with Bee Sweet Honey Ltd, marking the launch of a long-term and scalable beekeeping initiative. Under this partnership and over the next 3 years, Bee Sweet will deliver 6,000 hives to 200 households starting in Rufunsa and expanding into new CFP sites in Eastern Province.

The honey production program under the CFP addresses two of our main aims: First, to help reduce poverty and improve livelihoods, by generating income through the sale of high quality honey. Secondly, to help reduce deforestation, by creating an additional incentive for forest protection – as healthy bees require healthy, intact forests, to live in and make honey! Hives provided by Bee Sweet will last for many years – a stark contrast to the unsustainable traditional bark hives that local honey producers would have used.

Since 2012, BCP has been working with local communities neighbouring the protected forest of Rufunsa Conservancy, under the Lower Zambezi REDD+ Project (LZRP). The LZRP is the first and currently only verified REDD+ activity in Zambia. It is now receiving support under the USAID-funded CFP. Under the LZRP, and as part of the CFP, BCP has worked with the local community to identify and implement alternative livelihood projects. This beekeeping initiative is one of the first large-scale livelihood projects to be launched under the CFP.

In 2013-2014, a honey production pilot was funded through a VIGOR grant from USAID, to the BCP Trust. The partnership with Bee Sweet is an expansion of this successful pilot activity!

Bee Sweet was identified through a competitive application process to support the expansion of honey production activities under the CFP. They are experienced in honey production with local small scale farmers, and have a well-established market for honey products. In 2015, they exported over 300 tons of honey internationally! Bee Sweet already works with 12,000 farmers throughout Zambia, operating over 70,000 Top Bar beehives. They have been granted organic certification by ECOCERT (organic certification organization from France) in 2013 and 2015, and a HACCP (Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Point) certification is in progress.

The expansion of honey production activities with Bee Sweet has begun well. In July, three individuals from Rufunsa travelled to the Bee Sweet factories in Ndola, for mentorship training on beekeeping and honey making. They are now responsible for project operations through beehive installations, honey harvesting and storage, in Rufunsa. Following training, they returned with materials to initially assemble 1,000 top bar hives, which will be distributed to the beneficiaries they train. CFP and Bee Sweet partners will be on-the-ground throughout this launch. Since the longevity of beehives is 20-30 years, this partnership with Bee Sweet is anticipated to provide a regular and long-term market for honey. 37 people have received training in honey production already, and 2,000 hives have been delivered to Rufunsa for assembly and distribution by the mentors.

We are excited about the potential that this partnership has to bring meaningful benefits to local community stakeholders and partners. Based on current market calculations, if the beehives can achieve a standard 40% occupancy, communities can expect to earn as much as \$30,000 per year (K300,000), from honey production!



LEGO AND BAR SUCCESSFULLY GRADUATE ONTO ANTI- POACHING OPERATIONS IN LOWER ZAMBEZI

In Fiscal Year 2016, the USAID-funded Community Forests Program (CFP) supported the establishment of a mobile dog unit (or canine detection unit), to be based in the Lower Zambezi ecosystem, and to be managed through a partnership between Conservation Lower Zambezi (CLZ) and the Zambian Department of National Parks and Wildlife (DNPW). The mobile dog unit is set up to combat wildlife crime and poaching.

CFP provided a US\$150,000.00 sub grant to this unit, which includes a new modified Toyota Land Cruiser that will be used by the dog unit for special operations, making it an entirely independent unit that can randomly deploy across the highways and disrupt wildlife criminal chains. Funds from this same grant will pay the salaries of the four dog handlers for the first 2 years.

As part of the initial set-up phase of this partnership, the CFP funded the intensive training program for the dogs and their handlers. Trainers Mike Hensman and Jay Crafter, from Invictus K9 – an organization dedicated to canine training – spent 3 months working with the dogs (named: Lego and Bar) and their four selected (human!) handlers who are members from the local community. To pass the training, the dogs had to build up an acceptable level of fitness, to develop the ability to work around people, to develop the skill and strength to track for several kilometres, and to develop the ability to distinguish between 5 different scents. The handlers had an equally intensive training, which also required them to pass a fitness test, and be able to handle and bond with the dogs.

In August, following the intensive training, the dogs, handlers, CLZ staff and Board members, as well as the trainers, gathered together to celebrate this notable achievement. The dogs demonstrated their training by locating pangolin scales, ivory, firearms, and ammunition. The graduation further helped to instil confidence in the handlers, that they are undertaking a big step forward for the conservation and preservation of the Lower Zambezi National Park. During their speeches as part of the graduation ceremony, Ian Stevenson, the CEO of CLZ, and Jay, one of the trainers, encouraged the handlers to continue with their fantastic work and pushed for concrete results in terms of conservation outcomes. Riccardo Garbaccio, the CLZ Chairman, further emphasized that: “This day doesn’t just mark the end of your training, it marks the beginning of your operations and the need for results”.

In the few weeks following graduation, Lego and Bar have started operations in the field. Already, they have been remarkably successful: within their first few weeks in field, they were able to detect and help apprehend six people who possessed illegal bush meat. In September, the dog unit helped track down and apprehend two suspects who had snared a leopard.

The Lower Zambezi ecosystem is located close to major roads and the capital city. Poaching and deforestation from a growing population is putting intense pressure on the Lower Zambezi ecosystem. We are proud to support the development of this important new tool to reduce wildlife crime in the Lower Zambezi ecosystem.



DATA DETAILS POSITIVE IMPACTS OF REDD+

2017 marks five years of project implementation for the Lower Zambezi REDD+ Project (LZRP) – the first, and still only, REDD+ project in Zambia to be verified against the international Verified Carbon Standard (VCS).

During the course of the last five years, the LZRP has achieved four milestone VCS verifications and completed two rounds of annual revenue sharing with local community stakeholders, in 2016 and 2017. The fourth VCS verification of the LZRP took place in 2017, and is an important milestone achievement in and of itself – BCP is now one of only two REDD+ organizations in Africa that have successfully achieved four consecutive VCS verifications, and one of only six REDD+ implementers to achieve this recognition, globally. Additionally, the LZRP also remains one of the only VCS verified REDD+ projects in Africa to have achieved gold level validation against the Climate, Community and Biodiversity Standard for its exceptional climate, community and biodiversity benefits. These verifications all take place on the back of rigorous audits, including site visits, to confirm that our REDD+ activities are delivering positive community and conservation impacts.

Each member of the Forest Monitoring Team has been selected and hired from the local community and has been trained to scientifically measure and monitor the forest.



95% report that the LZRP benefits their community.

91% report receiving direct benefits to their household from the project.

75% report active participation in the LZRP by a member of their household

79% report understanding that the LZRP is a long-term project.

96% say CFP is welcome in the community.

Further to that, this year, the CFP has begun to receive data that is illustrating the real impacts of the LZRP on local communities and conservation.

In the fourth quarter of FY17, social monitoring follow-up surveys were undertaken among a representative sample of 100 community stakeholders living within the project zone for the LZRP. These surveys follow the initial socio-economic baseline study undertaken in 2012. The CFP is still finalizing the complete reports with consultants, but already some of the initial survey results illustrate encouraging successes for FY17.

While these are only preliminary results, we are excited to see such positive responses, which were reported by a neutral, external implementing partner. We look forward to further results in the upcoming quarter as the final survey reports are delivered.

The CFP can also report on an encouraging LZRP forest monitoring and management statistic. In FY17, the CFP reported for the first time “0 new deforestation incidents” in the project area for the LZRP throughout most of the year. This is an important milestone for the CFP as it indicates successful conservation activities including forest boundary monitoring activities such as patrols, as well as the culmination of five years of community engagement and livelihoods work. Together, these measures have helped to deter illegal forest violations and incentivise collaboration on forest protection and conservation. This statistic is especially impactful in light of the continued instances of confiscations and arrests in the surrounding Lower Zambezi ecosystem

CFP reporting to date is strongly indicating key successes for the project, and is serving as a powerful illustration of the potential of REDD+ projects to transform local mind-sets, livelihoods and conservation outcomes in critically threatened ecosystems.



CAPACITY BUILDING FOR 72 COMMUNITY INSTITUTIONS – PREPARING AND EMPOWERING COMMUNITIES FOR REDD+

It is said that “you can’t teach someone to drive, unless you hand over the keys to the car”; and “you can’t learn to swim until you get into the water.”

In line with this outlook, the CFP is promoting both theoretical and practical learning opportunities to aid the uptake of techniques for the effective management of natural and financial resources within local community institutions. The capacity building program is being undertaken as part of a Community Based Natural Resources Management (CBNRM) model for community-based REDD+ implementation under the CFP.

The CFP is currently working with 10 Community Resources Boards (CRBs) and 62 Village Action Groups (VAGs) as local community partners for REDD+ implementation. During the first quarter of FY17, the CFP undertook initial Governance Capacity Assessments for all 10 partner CRBs of the CFP to assess their baseline capacity to meet critical identified needs for REDD+ implementation and CBNRM.

Following the initial assessment, in the second quarter of FY17, the CFP facilitated Governance Capacity Building training for representatives from 10 CRBs and 60 VAGs. The assessment and training were collaboratively developed and co-facilitated by members of the CFP Technical team, working with representatives from key Government implementing partners including the Department of National Parks and Wildlife (DNPW) and the Forestry Department (FD). The training comprised an intensive four-day program that aimed to address key gaps identified in the initial assessments. Training topics included an overview of REDD+; introduction to the core principles of CBNRM; and introductions to financial resources management and natural resources management.

During the third quarter of FY17, an additional Financial Resources Management training was provided to relevant CRB members including accountants and book-keepers. The training delivered theoretical training in financial management as well as practical experience in maintaining financial records and accounting for funds. Participants were provided with financial management handbooks; copies of relevant SOPs for financial management; and templates to use for records-keeping and reporting. The training specifically covered aspects of 'best practice' related to transparent and accountable management of community funds, with the aim of addressing identified areas of risk that other, previous attempts at CBNRM-type projects had flagged as needing improvement in order for CBNRM to work.

As of the fourth quarter of FY17, the communities are ready to take on responsibility and management of their CFP goals, with partner support. During this quarter, the CFP completed delivery of the first round of Conservation Fees and signed Conservation MOUs with all 10 CRBs. These are critical steps towards effectively recognizing and empowering CRBs and VAGs as local community institutions responsible for the effective management of their own financial and natural resources. With the continued support of representatives from the CFP Engagement Team, CRBs are engaged in an ongoing mentoring program through our new "2/4 operational model" that provides bi-weekly site-visits to local implementing partners, with the aim of providing regular support. The CFP has additionally provided equipment and trained staff members to provide full-time support.

BCP is excited to watch as the CRBs continue to take ownership of their conservation goals, with CFP support, through a community-led approach to REDD+!



USAID PARTNERSHIP RENOVATES NORTHERN ENTRANCE TO LOWER ZAMBEZI NATIONAL PARK

On 17 December, 2018, a ceremony was held to formally re-open the newly renovated Mukamba Gate Complex in Zambia Lower Zambezi National Park. The colourful event was the largest in CFP's history and was attended by the Minister of Tourism and Arts, Honorable Charles Banda, the U.S. Ambassador to Zambia, His Excellency Daniel L. Foote, members of USAID/Zambia's Economic Development office, Department of National Parks and Wildlife (DNPW) representatives, CFP employees and local community members.

Mukamba Gate is the northern entry way to Lower Zambezi National Park and borders Lower Zambezi REDD+ project. Refurbishment of the Gate complex was funded by the United States Agency for International Development (USAID) Community Forests Program—the flagship activity for USAID/Zambia's forest conservation and rural livelihood initiatives—and aims to support the critical work of DNPW in protecting the Park from wildlife crime and habitat loss by enhancing security measures.

The complex now boasts of an improved security checkpoint and office building as well as housing facilities for Wildlife Police Officers. The \$80,000 infrastructure investment was selected by DNPW as a priority project to enhance security facilities at the Gate.



“Conservation of these areas of significant biodiversity is a large task that requires constant effort by DNPW and the Forestry Department. We are pleased for the opportunity to collaborate with the Zambian government to address our shared concern for Zambia’s environment and wildlife,” said CFP COP, Dr Hassan Sachedina.

“It is critical in this time of growing pressures from population expansion and climate change that organisations and government work together to maximise positive outcomes for Zambia’s wildlife, forests and communities.”

Through habitat protection, local communities can benefit from tourism income as well as revenue shares from carbon offset sales. Income generation is crucial within these rural areas to ensure adequate social service development to meet the growing population demand.

“If we lose Zambia’s forests and wildlife, we lose a critical driver of economic growth for our local communities,” said United States Ambassador to Zambia Daniel L. Foote. “Activities such as wildlife tourism and bee keeping are only possible through conservation.”

The Mukamba Gate refurbishment project is just one of many collaborative projects between CFP and DNPW, enabled through USAID funding for the Community Forests Program.



ANNEX D: INDEX OF CFP DOCUMENTS

REPORT/DOCUMENT	DETAILS	PRODUCED
Analysis of the agents, drivers and underlying causes of deforestation for the CFP in Zambia	This report presents the results of the analysis of agents, drivers and underlying causes of deforestation undertaken as part of the requirements for developing the BCP Community Forests Program (CFP) according to the VCS carbon accounting methodology: VM0015 Methodology for Avoided Unplanned Deforestation, version 1.1. BCP will applied this methodology to quantify emissions reductions generated by the project. Step 3 of the methodology requires undertaking an analysis of the main agents, drivers, and underlying causes of deforestation and their likely future development.	2018
CFP Monitoring Evaluation and Learning Plan(Most Recently updated)	This document is the most recent revised version of the USAID- funded CFPs monitoring and evaluation plan. It outlines the CFP approach towards measuring short and medium term outputs and outcomes in the implementation of the program.	2018
FY 14 Annual Work Plan	This document outlines the annual measureable activities and times lines associated during the financial year FY 14 of the USAID-funded CFP.	2014
FY 15 Annual Work Plan	This document outlines the annual measureable activities and times lines associated during the financial year FY 15 of the USAID-funded CFP.	2015
FY 16 Annual Work Plan	This document outlines the annual measureable activities and times lines associated during the financial year FY 16 of the USAID-funded CFP.	2016
FY 17 Annual Work Plan	This document outlines the annual measureable activities and times lines associated during the financial year FY 17 of the USAID-funded CFP.	2017
FY 18 Annual Work Plan	This document outlines the annual measureable activities and times lines associated during the financial year FY 18 of the USAID-funded CFP.	2018
FY 14 Annual Report	This documents captures the performance of the CFP across its key result areas and activities associated with the overall goal of the CFP	2014

REPORT/DOCUMENT	DETAILS	PRODUCED
FY 15 Annual Report	This documents captures the performance of the CFP across its key result areas and activities associated with the overall goal of the CFP	2015
FY 16 Annual Report	This documents captures the performance of the CFP across its key result areas and activities associated with the overall goal of the CFP	2016
FY 17 Annual Report	This documents captures the performance of the CFP across its key result areas and activities associated with the overall goal of the CFP	2017
FY 18 Annual Report	This documents captures the performance of the CFP across its key result areas and activities associated with the overall goal of the CFP	2018
Impact Evaluation of the Community-Based Forest Management Program Report on Baseline Findings	This Baseline Report analyzes baseline data from an impact evaluation (IE) of the United States Agency for International Development (USAID)-funded Community-based Forest Management Program (CFP) in Zambia. This baseline survey analysis has three objectives: 1) to improve understanding of the program context in the evaluation area; 2) to provide baseline estimates of key indicators and outcomes under investigation, which provides a benchmark for evaluating the eventual impacts of CFP; and, 3) to provide an exploratory assessment of baseline differences across the IE comparison (intervention) groups that will be used to measure CFP's impacts.	2016
LZRP Baseline Social Monitoring Survey Report	This survey report documents the baseline or "pre-project"/"without-project" economic and livelihood conditions of the local communities, so as to allow for ongoing monitoring and evaluation, and for future assessment of the impacts that BCP's REDD+ Project has on local communities.	2012
LZRP Follow up Social Monitoring Survey Report	This report contains key findings of the Follow up Social Monitoring Survey commissioned by BCP. The Survey was conducted by Mint Advisory Services Limited. The main purpose of the survey was to assess the Socio-Economic status of stakeholder households living within the Project Zone for the LZRP across 4 community zones in Bunda-Bunda Chiefdom, Rufunsa District.	2017

